

★ THE TRIVIA SERIES — BOOK 4 ★

FORBIDDEN HISTORY

Shocking Trivia They Didn't Teach You in School

630 Questions · 14 Chapters · The Stories History Class Skipped
Fact Bombs · True or False · Multiple Choice · Quick Fire · Stump Your
Friends!

Ahmad Asad

The Trivia Series

Forbidden History

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This book deals with historical events, including violence, atrocities, and other mature subject matter. Reader discretion is advised.

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Fact Bombs · True or False (10 pts) · Multiple Choice (10 pts) · Quick Fire (10 pts) · Stump Your Friends! (15 pts)

*Answer Keys**Score Summary & Knowledge Rank*

Total questions: **630** · Chapters: **14** · Points available: **630**

How This Book Works

Each chapter begins with **10 verified historical facts** you almost certainly were never taught — then tests whether they landed through four scored rounds. A fifth, harder round expands your knowledge beyond the facts.

ROUND 1 FACT BOMBS

10 documented, often disturbing facts. Read carefully — your scored rounds depend on them.

ROUND 2 TRUE OR FALSE (10 pts)

10 statements based on the Fact Bombs. Score 1 point per correct answer.

ROUND 3 COULD YOU HAVE GUESSED? (10 pts)

10 multiple choice questions on the facts. Four options per question.

ROUND 4 QUICK FIRE (10 pts)

10 short-answer historical questions. No options — pure recall.

ROUND 5 STUMP YOUR FRIENDS! (15 pts)

15 harder questions that separate history enthusiasts from genuine experts.

TOTAL 45 points per chapter × 14 chapters = 630 total points.

KNOWLEDGE RANK

567–630 ★★★★★ GRAND HISTORIAN — You know what most history books leave out.

504–566 ★★★★★ KNOWLEDGE CHAMPION — Exceptional grasp of forbidden history.

378–503 ★★★★★ CURIOUS SCHOLAR — Strong foundations, room to deepen.

252–377 ★★★★★ KEEN LEARNER — The hidden history is calling. Keep reading.

Below 252 ★★★★★ APPRENTICE — Everyone starts here. The real history awaits.

CHAPTER 01 • FORBIDDEN HISTORY

Ancient Atrocities They Skipped Over

Your school history book made antiquity sound like marble statues and noble philosophers. The reality involved organised mass murder, ritual torture, and depravities that would horrify a modern war crimes tribunal.

ROUND 1 — FACT BOMBS

Read all 10 facts carefully. Your scored rounds follow.

FACT #1

The Roman general Crassus crucified 6,000 captured rebels along the Appian Way after defeating Spartacus in 71 BC. The crosses lined the road for 200 kilometres as a deliberate warning. Many took days to die.

★ *A 200km open-air torture exhibit, sponsored by Rome.*

FACT #2

The Aztecs sacrificed an estimated 20,000 people in a single four-day ceremony in 1487 to dedicate the Great Pyramid of Tenochtitlán. Captives were lined up for miles, climbing the steps to the top.

★ *A four-day production line for human sacrifice.*

FACT #3

Carthaginians practised infant sacrifice to the god Baal Hammon — confirmed by archaeological evidence from the Tophet burial ground containing thousands of charred infant remains in urns.

★ *A religion that required burning your own children.*

FACT #4

The Assyrian Empire perfected psychological warfare through public flaying. Defeated kings were skinned alive and their skins nailed to city gates as warnings.

Records of this from 700 BC show kings boasting about it.

★ *Ancient PR was skin-deep. Literally.*

FACT #5

Roman Emperor Tiberius retired to Capri to escape Rome and conducted decades of documented sexual abuse against children — a fact preserved in Suetonius and Tacitus but rarely taught in schools.

★ *A Roman emperor most history teachers refuse to discuss honestly.*

FACT #6

The ancient Persian execution method "scaphism" involved sealing the victim between two boats with their face, hands and feet exposed, force-feeding them milk and honey, and leaving them to be eaten alive by insects over weeks.

★ *A method of execution designed to take seventeen days.*

FACT #7

Spartan boys were systematically beaten, starved, and forced to murder enslaved Helots as part of their state-mandated military training (the Agōgē). It began at age seven.

★ *A society that legally required child soldiers to commit murder.*

FACT #8

The Inca Empire practised "capacocha" — child sacrifice on mountaintops. Frozen mummies of children as young as six have been discovered, drugged with coca leaves and chicha beer before being killed.

★ *A religious practice that selected children for their beauty before killing them.*

FACT #9

Caligula, Roman emperor from 37–41 AD, allegedly made his horse Incitatus a senator and once declared war on the sea, ordering his soldiers to attack the waves and collect seashells as "spoils of war."

★ *An emperor who declared war on water.*

FACT #10

Mongol warriors under Genghis Khan killed an estimated 40 million people during their conquests —

approximately 10% of the world's entire population at the time.

★ *One man's armies killed every tenth human being on Earth.*

ROUND 2**True or False (10 statements · 1 pt each)**

Based on the Fact Bombs above.

1. Crassus crucified 6,000 rebels along the Appian Way.
TRUE / FALSE
2. The Aztecs sacrificed approximately 20,000 people in a single 1487 ceremony.
TRUE / FALSE
3. Carthaginian infant sacrifice has no archaeological evidence.
TRUE / FALSE
4. Assyrians publicly flayed defeated kings and displayed their skins.
TRUE / FALSE
5. Tiberius spent his retirement years on Capri.
TRUE / FALSE
6. Scaphism was designed as a quick execution.
TRUE / FALSE
7. Spartan boys began military training at age seven.
TRUE / FALSE
8. Inca capacocha sacrifices targeted only adult prisoners.
TRUE / FALSE
9. Caligula declared war on the sea according to Roman sources.
TRUE / FALSE
10. Mongol conquests killed approximately 10% of the world population.
TRUE / FALSE

ROUND 3**Could You Have Guessed? (10 questions · 1 pt each)**

Four options — choose the correct one.

1. How long did the Appian Way crucifixions extend?
 - A. 50 km
 - B. 100 km
 - C. 200 km
 - D. 500 km

- 2. How many people were sacrificed in the 1487 Aztec ceremony?**
 - A. 2,000
 - B. 5,000
 - C. 20,000
 - D. 50,000
- 3. What was the duration of scaphism execution?**
 - A. Hours
 - B. A few days
 - C. Around 17 days
 - D. A month
- 4. At what age did Spartan boys begin military training?**
 - A. Five
 - B. Seven
 - C. Ten
 - D. Twelve
- 5. Which substance were Inca child sacrifices given before death?**
 - A. Wine
 - B. Coca leaves and chicha beer
 - C. Opium
 - D. Mushrooms
- 6. Approximately what world population percentage did Mongol conquests kill?**
 - A. 1%
 - B. 5%
 - C. 10%
 - D. 25%
- 7. Caligula allegedly tried to make which animal a senator?**
 - A. His dog
 - B. His eagle
 - C. His horse
 - D. His lion
- 8. Where did Tiberius retire to commit abuses?**
 - A. Sicily
 - B. Capri
 - C. Crete

D. Cyprus

9. Carthaginian sacrifices were made to which god?

- A. Moloch**
- B. Baal Hammon**
- C. Tanit**
- D. Eshmun**

10. Assyrian psychological warfare prominently featured:

- A. Public crucifixion**
- B. Public flaying**
- C. Mass blinding**
- D. Tower-building from skulls**

ROUND 4**Quick Fire (10 questions · 1 pt each)**

Short answers — no options. Write from memory.

1. Who was the Roman general defeated at Cannae?

Answer:

2. In what year did Rome fall to the Visigoths?

Answer:

3. Who was the founder of the Mongol Empire?

Answer:

4. What was the capital of the Aztec Empire?

Answer:

5. Which civilisation built Machu Picchu?

Answer:

6. Who succeeded Caligula as emperor?

Answer:

7. In what year was Pompeii destroyed?

Answer:

8. What was the Spartan training system called?

Answer:

9. Who was Hannibal's home city?

Answer:

10. What event triggered the fall of the Western Roman Empire?

Answer:

ROUND 5**Stump Your Friends! (15 harder questions · 1 pt each)**

The expert round. No mercy.

- 1. Which Roman emperor reportedly ordered his soldiers to collect seashells as spoils of war?**
 - A. Nero
 - B. Caligula
 - C. Commodus
 - D. Elagabalus
- 2. The Battle of Cannae killed approximately how many Romans in a single day?**
 - A. 10,000
 - B. 20,000
 - C. 50,000
 - D. 70,000
- 3. Which Egyptian pharaoh's tomb was discovered in 1922?**
 - A. Ramses II
 - B. Tutankhamun
 - C. Akhenaten
 - D. Khufu
- 4. The Assyrian capital sacked in 612 BC was:**
 - A. Babylon
 - B. Nineveh
 - C. Ur
 - D. Susa
- 5. Who was the Roman emperor during the eruption of Vesuvius?**
 - A. Vespasian
 - B. Titus
 - C. Domitian
 - D. Nerva
- 6. The "Sea Peoples" caused the Late Bronze Age Collapse around:**
 - A. 1900 BC
 - B. 1500 BC
 - C. 1200 BC
 - D. 800 BC
- 7. Which Greek city-state defeated Persia at Marathon (490 BC)?**
 - A. Sparta

- B. Thebes
- C. Athens
- D. Corinth

8. Caligula reigned for how many years before his assassination?

- A. Less than 4
- B. 7
- C. 11
- D. 15

9. The Inca Empire was conquered by which Spanish conquistador?

- A. Cortés
- B. Pizarro
- C. Balboa
- D. de Soto

10. How many emperors did Rome have in the "Year of the Four Emperors" (69 AD)?

- A. Three
- B. Four
- C. Five
- D. Six

11. The Carthaginian Tophet burial ground is located in modern:

- A. Libya
- B. Tunisia
- C. Algeria
- D. Morocco

12. Who was the Roman emperor when Christianity was legalised?

- A. Diocletian
- B. Constantine
- C. Theodosius
- D. Julian

13. The Mongol siege of Baghdad in 1258 destroyed which institution?

- A. The Great Library
- B. The House of Wisdom
- C. The Grand Mosque

D. The Royal Mint

14. What was the population of Rome at its peak?

- A. 500,000
- B. 1 million
- C. 2 million
- D. 5 million

15. Which Roman emperor was the last "Five Good Emperors"?

- A. Trajan
- B. Hadrian
- C. Antoninus Pius
- D. Marcus Aurelius

MY SCORE: Q1 _____ Q2 _____ Q3 _____ Q4 _____ Q5 _____ Q6 _____
TOTAL: _____/45

CHAPTER NOTE *Ancient civilisations were not innocent of barbarism — they invented many of its templates. The reason history textbooks soften these stories is partly cultural sensitivity, partly because the truth is genuinely too disturbing to teach to children.*

CHAPTER 1 — ANSWER KEY

Round 2 — True or False

1. Crassus crucified 6,000 rebels along the Appian Way. → **TRUE**
2. The Aztecs sacrificed approximately 20,000 people in a single 148 → **TRUE**
3. Carthaginian infant sacrifice has no archaeological evidence. → **FALSE**
4. Assyrians publicly flayed defeated kings and displayed their skin → **TRUE**
5. Tiberius spent his retirement years on Capri. → **TRUE**
6. Scaphism was designed as a quick execution. → **FALSE**
7. Spartan boys began military training at age seven. → **TRUE**
8. Inca capacocha sacrifices targeted only adult prisoners. → **FALSE**
9. Caligula declared war on the sea according to Roman sources. → **TRUE**
10. Mongol conquests killed approximately 10% of the world population → **TRUE**

Round 3 — Multiple Choice

1. How long did the Appian Way crucifixions extend? → **C. 200 km**
2. How many people were sacrificed in the 1487 Aztec cerem → **C. 20,000**
3. What was the duration of scaphism execution? → **C. Around 17 days**
4. At what age did Spartan boys begin military training? → **B. Seven**
5. Which substance were Inca child sacrifices given before → **B. Coca leaves and chicha beer**
6. Approximately what world population percentage did Mong → **C. 10%**
7. Caligula allegedly tried to make which animal a senator → **C. His horse**
8. Where did Tiberius retire to commit abuses? → **B. Capri**
9. Carthaginian sacrifices were made to which god? → **B. Baal Hammon**
10. Assyrian psychological warfare prominently featured: → **B. Public flaying**

Round 4 — Quick Fire

1. Who was the Roman general defeated at Cannae? → **Varro (defeated by Hannibal)**
2. In what year did Rome fall to the Visigoths? → **410 AD**
3. Who was the founder of the Mongol Empire? → **Genghis Khan (Temüjin)**
4. What was the capital of the Aztec Empire? → **Tenochtitlán**
5. Which civilisation built Machu Picchu? → **The Inca**
6. Who succeeded Caligula as emperor? → **Claudius**
7. In what year was Pompeii destroyed? → **79 AD**
8. What was the Spartan training system called? → **The Agōgē**
9. Who was Hannibal's home city? → **Carthage**
10. What event triggered the fall of the Western Roman Empire? → **The deposition of Romulus Augustulus in 476 AD**

Round 5 — Stump Your Friends!

1. Which Roman emperor reportedly ordered his soldiers to → **B. Caligula**
2. The Battle of Cannae killed approximately how many Roma → **C. 50,000**
3. Which Egyptian pharaoh's tomb was discovered in 1922? → **B. Tutankhamun**
4. The Assyrian capital sacked in 612 BC was: → **B. Nineveh**
5. Who was the Roman emperor during the eruption of Vesuvi → **B. Titus**
6. The "Sea Peoples" caused the Late Bronze Age Collapse a → **C. 1200 BC**
7. Which Greek city-state defeated Persia at Marathon (490 → **C. Athens**
8. Caligula reigned for how many years before his assassin → **A. Less than 4**
9. The Inca Empire was conquered by which Spanish conquist → **B. Pizarro**
10. How many emperors did Rome have in the "Year of the Fou → **B. Four**
11. The Carthaginian Tophet burial ground is located in mod → **B. Tunisia**
12. Who was the Roman emperor when Christianity was legalis → **B. Constantine**
13. The Mongol siege of Baghdad in 1258 destroyed which ins → **B. The House of Wisdom**
14. What was the population of Rome at its peak? → **B. 1 million**
15. Which Roman emperor was the last "Five Good Emperors"? → **D. Marcus Aurelius**

CHAPTER 02 • FORBIDDEN HISTORY

Medieval Cruelties & Forgotten Tortures

The Middle Ages were not just Knights and dragons. They were a thousand years of legally sanctioned torture, witch hunts, plague pits, and casual brutality that history class glossed over in a single afternoon.

ROUND 1 — FACT BOMBS

Read all 10 facts carefully. Your scored rounds follow.

FACT #1

The Spanish Inquisition tortured an estimated 150,000 people over 350 years. The "Strappado" — hanging victims from their wrists tied behind their backs until shoulders dislocated — was one of dozens of approved methods.

★ *A religious institution with an HR-approved torture manual.*

FACT #2

Medieval witch trials in Europe killed an estimated 40,000–60,000 people between 1400 and 1782, with roughly 80% being women. The "swimming test" (drown if innocent, burn if floating) had no possible passing outcome.

★ *A justice system designed so the accused always loses.*

FACT #3

The Black Death (1347–1352) killed approximately 25 million people in Europe — between one-third and one-half of the entire continental population. Some villages had no survivors at all.

★ *A pandemic that erased entire towns from the map.*

FACT #4

The "Iron Maiden" torture device may not have actually existed in the Middle Ages. The famous one in

Nuremberg appears to have been fabricated in the 18th century. The myth is more famous than the truth.

★ *The most famous medieval torture device is probably a hoax.*

FACT #5

During the Crusades (1096–1291), Christian armies killed Jews, Muslims and even fellow Christians indiscriminately. The 1099 Sack of Jerusalem killed an estimated 40,000 inhabitants in three days.

★ *A religious war that did not discriminate by religion.*

FACT #6

Vlad III "the Impaler" of Wallachia impaled an estimated 80,000 Ottoman soldiers and political enemies on long wooden stakes — sometimes arranged in geometric patterns called "forests of the impaled."

★ *A ruler whose nickname described his preferred punishment.*

FACT #7

The "Brazen Bull" was a hollow bronze bull statue used in ancient Greece and revived in medieval Europe. Victims were sealed inside while a fire was lit beneath; their screams were channelled through tubes to sound like a bull bellowing.

★ *A torture device designed to be musically grotesque.*

FACT #8

Medieval surgeons performed trepanation — drilling holes in the skull — to "release evil spirits." Some patients survived; archaeological evidence shows healed skulls. Most did not.

★ *Brain surgery, with no anaesthetic, performed by people who believed in demons.*

FACT #9

The "Pear of Anguish" was a metal device inserted into a victim's mouth, anus, or vagina, then expanded with a screw mechanism. Like the Iron Maiden, its medieval authenticity is now disputed by historians.

★ *Some "medieval" tortures were Victorian inventions sold to museums.*

FACT #10

The "Cathar Crusade" (1209–1229) saw Pope Innocent III order the extermination of the Cathar Christian sect in southern France. The papal legate at Béziers reportedly said "Kill them all, God will recognise his own" — 20,000 died.

★ *A pope who ordered Christians to kill Christians, sorted out by God later.*

ROUND 2**True or False (10 statements · 1 pt each)**

Based on the Fact Bombs above.

1. The Spanish Inquisition lasted approximately 350 years.
TRUE / FALSE
2. European witch trials killed approximately 40,000–60,000 people.
TRUE / FALSE
3. The Black Death killed up to half of Europe's population.
TRUE / FALSE
4. The Iron Maiden's medieval authenticity is well-documented.
TRUE / FALSE
5. The 1099 Sack of Jerusalem killed about 40,000 people in three days.
TRUE / FALSE
6. Vlad the Impaler killed an estimated 80,000 people via impalement.
TRUE / FALSE
7. The Brazen Bull was designed to amplify the victim's screams as bellows.
TRUE / FALSE
8. Trepanation involved drilling into the skull.
TRUE / FALSE
9. The Pear of Anguish has confirmed medieval origins.
TRUE / FALSE
10. The Cathar Crusade was ordered by Pope Innocent III.
TRUE / FALSE

ROUND 3**Could You Have Guessed? (10 questions · 1 pt each)**

Four options — choose the correct one.

1. **How many people did the Spanish Inquisition torture over 350 years?**
 - A. 10,000
 - B. 50,000
 - C. 150,000

- D. 500,000**
- 2. Approximately what percentage of European witch trial victims were women?**
- A. 50%**
 - B. 65%**
 - C. 80%**
 - D. 95%**
- 3. How many died in the 1099 Sack of Jerusalem?**
- A. 5,000**
 - B. 15,000**
 - C. 40,000**
 - D. 100,000**
- 4. How many did Vlad the Impaler kill via impalement?**
- A. 10,000**
 - B. 30,000**
 - C. 80,000**
 - D. 150,000**
- 5. The Brazen Bull was used in:**
- A. Egypt only**
 - B. Ancient Greece and revived in medieval Europe**
 - C. Medieval France only**
 - D. Roman Empire only**
- 6. How many died in the Cathar Crusade?**
- A. 5,000**
 - B. 10,000**
 - C. 20,000**
 - D. 50,000**
- 7. Which pope ordered the Cathar Crusade?**
- A. Gregory IX**
 - B. Urban II**
 - C. Innocent III**
 - D. Boniface VIII**
- 8. The Black Death struck Europe primarily during which years?**
- A. 1247–1252**
 - B. 1347–1352**
 - C. 1447–1452**
 - D. 1547–1552**

9. The "swimming test" for witches:

- A. Was a fair trial
- B. Had no possible passing outcome
- C. Required a confession only
- D. Was used only on men

10. Trepanation was performed to:

- A. Cure infections
- B. Release evil spirits
- C. Improve hearing
- D. Increase intelligence

ROUND 4**Quick Fire (10 questions · 1 pt each)**

Short answers — no options. Write from memory.

1. In what year did the Black Death first reach Europe?

Answer:

2. Who led the First Crusade?

Answer:

3. What was the Magna Carta?

Answer:

4. Who was the founder of Islam?

Answer:

5. In what year did the Hundred Years War begin?

Answer:

6. What event ended the Byzantine Empire?

Answer:

7. What was the Hanseatic League?

Answer:

8. Who painted The Garden of Earthly Delights?

Answer:

9. In what year was Joan of Arc burned at the stake?

Answer:

10. What was the Holy Roman Empire?

Answer:

ROUND 5**Stump Your Friends! (15 harder questions · 1 pt each)**

The expert round. No mercy.

- 1. The Children's Crusade of 1212 ended in what way?**
 - A. Successful capture of Jerusalem
 - B. Most children died or were sold into slavery
 - C. They returned home safely
 - D. They founded a new religious order
- 2. Who was the longest-reigning English monarch of the medieval period?**
 - A. Edward III
 - B. Henry III
 - C. Edward I
 - D. Richard I
- 3. The Battle of Hastings (1066) was won by:**
 - A. Harold Godwinson
 - B. William the Conqueror
 - C. Harald Hardrada
 - D. Edward the Confessor
- 4. Which medieval institution conducted the Inquisition?**
 - A. The English Crown
 - B. The Catholic Church
 - C. The Holy Roman Empire
 - D. The Order of the Knights Templar
- 5. What was the Albigensian Crusade?**
 - A. A campaign against Albanians
 - B. Another name for the Cathar Crusade
 - C. A naval campaign in the Mediterranean
 - D. A war against the Mongols
- 6. Genghis Khan was succeeded by which son?**
 - A. Jochi
 - B. Chagatai
 - C. Ögedei
 - D. Tolui
- 7. The "Babylonian Captivity" of the papacy was based in:**
 - A. Rome
 - B. Avignon
 - C. Florence
 - D. Geneva

- 8. The Knights Templar were officially disbanded in:**
- A. 1212
 - B. 1291
 - C. 1312
 - D. 1453
- 9. The Mongol invasion of Europe was halted by:**
- A. Russian winter
 - B. Death of Ögedei Khan
 - C. Polish defence at Legnica
 - D. Hungarian alliance
- 10. Which medieval king was nicknamed "Lionheart"?**
- A. Henry II
 - B. Edward I
 - C. Richard I
 - D. John
- 11. The Bubonic Plague is caused by which bacterium?**
- A. Yersinia pestis
 - B. Vibrio cholerae
 - C. Mycobacterium tuberculosis
 - D. Bacillus anthracis
- 12. The Norman Conquest of England occurred in which year?**
- A. 1042
 - B. 1066
 - C. 1087
 - D. 1100
- 13. Which medieval philosopher wrote Summa Theologica?**
- A. Augustine
 - B. Anselm
 - C. Thomas Aquinas
 - D. Bonaventure
- 14. The Pope who initiated the First Crusade was:**
- A. Gregory VII
 - B. Urban II
 - C. Paschal II
 - D. Calixtus II
- 15. Vlad the Impaler ruled which historical region?**

- A. Transylvania
- B. Wallachia
- C. Moldavia
- D. Bulgaria

MY SCORE: Q3: ____ /10 Q4: ____ /10 Q5: ____ /10 Q6: ____ /10
TOTAL: ____/45

CHAPTER NOTE *Medieval Europe was simultaneously a society of profound religious devotion and astonishing cruelty. The two were not contradictions — they were components of the same worldview, in which suffering had moral meaning and brutality could be a form of piety.*

CHAPTER 2 — ANSWER KEY

Round 2 — True or False

1. The Spanish Inquisition lasted approximately 350 years. → **TRUE**
2. European witch trials killed approximately 40,000–60,000 people. → **TRUE**
3. The Black Death killed up to half of Europe's population. → **TRUE**
4. The Iron Maiden's medieval authenticity is well-documented. → **FALSE**
5. The 1099 Sack of Jerusalem killed about 40,000 people in three da → **TRUE**
6. Vlad the Impaler killed an estimated 80,000 people via impalement → **TRUE**
7. The Brazen Bull was designed to amplify the victim's screams as b → **TRUE**
8. Trepanation involved drilling into the skull. → **TRUE**
9. The Pear of Anguish has confirmed medieval origins. → **FALSE**
10. The Cathar Crusade was ordered by Pope Innocent III. → **TRUE**

Round 3 — Multiple Choice

1. How many people did the Spanish Inquisition torture ove → **C. 150,000**
2. Approximately what percentage of European witch trial v → **C. 80%**
3. How many died in the 1099 Sack of Jerusalem? → **C. 40,000**
4. How many did Vlad the Impaler kill via impalement? → **C. 80,000**
5. The Brazen Bull was used in: → **B. Ancient Greece and revived in medieval Europe**
6. How many died in the Cathar Crusade? → **C. 20,000**
7. Which pope ordered the Cathar Crusade? → **C. Innocent III**
8. The Black Death struck Europe primarily during which ye → **B. 1347–1352**
9. The "swimming test" for witches: → **B. Had no possible passing outcome**
10. Trepanation was performed to: → **B. Release evil spirits**

Round 4 — Quick Fire

1. In what year did the Black Death first reach Europe? → **1347**
2. Who led the First Crusade? → **Pope Urban II called for it; Godfrey of Bouillon led it militarily**
3. What was the Magna Carta? → **A charter of rights signed in 1215 limiting royal power in England**
4. Who was the founder of Islam? → **Muhammad**
5. In what year did the Hundred Years War begin? → **1337**
6. What event ended the Byzantine Empire? → **The fall of Constantinople in 1453**
7. What was the Hanseatic League? → **A medieval commercial federation of merchant guilds and market towns**
8. Who painted The Garden of Earthly Delights? → **Hieronymus Bosch**
9. In what year was Joan of Arc burned at the stake? → **1431**

10. What was the Holy Roman Empire? → A multi-ethnic complex of European territories under a Holy Roman Emperor

Round 5 — Stump Your Friends!

- 1. The Children's Crusade of 1212 ended in what way? → B. Most children died or were sold into slavery**
- 2. Who was the longest-reigning English monarch of the med → B. Henry III**
- 3. The Battle of Hastings (1066) was won by: → B. William the Conqueror**
- 4. Which medieval institution conducted the Inquisition? → B. The Catholic Church**
- 5. What was the Albigensian Crusade? → B. Another name for the Cathar Crusade**
- 6. Genghis Khan was succeeded by which son? → C. Ögedei**
- 7. The "Babylonian Captivity" of the papacy was based in: → B. Avignon**
- 8. The Knights Templar were officially disbanded in: → C. 1312**
- 9. The Mongol invasion of Europe was halted by: → B. Death of Ögedei Khan**
- 10. Which medieval king was nicknamed "Lionheart"? → C. Richard I**
- 11. The Bubonic Plague is caused by which bacterium? → A. Yersinia pestis**
- 12. The Norman Conquest of England occurred in which year? → B. 1066**
- 13. Which medieval philosopher wrote Summa Theologica? → C. Thomas Aquinas**
- 14. The Pope who initiated the First Crusade was: → B. Urban II**
- 15. Vlad the Impaler ruled which historical region? → B. Wallachia**

CHAPTER 03 • FORBIDDEN HISTORY

Forbidden Royal Scandals & The Truth About Kings

School history teaches you that monarchs were strategic visionaries. The actual records show drunkards, lunatics, syphilitics, and serial murderers — many wearing crowns at the time.

ROUND 1 — FACT BOMBS

Read all 10 facts carefully. Your scored rounds follow.

FACT #1

King George III of Britain — the king who lost America — suffered from severe mental illness now believed to be either bipolar disorder or porphyria. He had to be physically restrained for entire stretches of his reign.

★ *The British Empire's greatest defeat came from a king who was, at times, clinically insane.*

FACT #2

Henry VIII of England executed two of his six wives, divorced two more, and the remaining two outlived him only narrowly. He also killed an estimated 72,000 people during his 38-year reign — political and religious enemies.

★ *A king with a worse marriage mortality rate than most wars.*

FACT #3

Russian Empress Catherine the Great is the subject of a persistent (but apparently false) rumour about dying during sex with a horse. She actually died of a stroke at 67. The slander was political propaganda after her death.

★ *A historical lie repeated for 250 years.*

FACT #4

King Charles VI of France believed for years that he was made of glass and would shatter if anyone touched him. He insisted on wearing iron rods in his clothes for protection. He ruled France for 42 years.

★ *The French throne occupied by a king afraid of breaking himself.*

FACT #5

Queen Christina of Sweden — one of the few female monarchs of the era — abdicated in 1654 to convert to Catholicism, dressed as a man for most of her life, and is now widely believed to have been intersex or transgender.

★ *A 17th-century monarch whose identity defied every category her era had.*

FACT #6

King Frederick William I of Prussia kidnapped exceptionally tall men from across Europe to form his "Potsdam Giants" regiment. He paid them well, forced them to marry tall women, and tried to breed taller soldiers.

★ *A king running a tall-people breeding programme.*

FACT #7

Queen Elizabeth I of England had black-stained teeth from her addiction to sugar — a luxury so rare and expensive that black teeth became a fashionable status symbol among English nobles, who deliberately blackened theirs.

★ *A status symbol so weird that English aristocrats deliberately ruined their own teeth.*

FACT #8

King Louis XIV of France took only one bath as an adult, on doctor's advice, and reportedly hated the experience. He used perfume and clothing changes instead. The Versailles court he ruled smelled accordingly.

★ *The Sun King apparently smelled like a sun-warmed corpse.*

FACT #9

Tsar Peter the Great of Russia personally executed Streltsy rebels by decapitation in 1698, beheading at least five with his own axe. He also collected human

teeth and would extract them from courtiers as a hobby.

★ *A tsar with a side hobby of dental tooth collection by force.*

FACT #10

King Edward II of England was reportedly murdered in 1327 by having a red-hot poker inserted into his anus — a punishment chosen because it would leave no external marks while killing him for being homosexual.

★ *The most infamously cruel royal murder in English history.*

ROUND 2**True or False (10 statements · 1 pt each)**

Based on the Fact Bombs above.

1. George III suffered severe mental illness, possibly porphyria.
TRUE / FALSE
2. Henry VIII executed two of his six wives.
TRUE / FALSE
3. Catherine the Great actually died from a horse-related accident.
TRUE / FALSE
4. Charles VI of France believed he was made of glass.
TRUE / FALSE
5. Queen Christina of Sweden converted to Catholicism after abdicating.
TRUE / FALSE
6. Frederick William I tried to breed taller soldiers.
TRUE / FALSE
7. Black teeth became a status symbol in Elizabethan England.
TRUE / FALSE
8. Louis XIV bathed regularly throughout his life.
TRUE / FALSE
9. Peter the Great personally executed prisoners by beheading.
TRUE / FALSE
10. Edward II's alleged murder was done in a way to leave no external marks.
TRUE / FALSE

ROUND 3**Could You Have Guessed? (10 questions · 1 pt each)**

Four options — choose the correct one.

1. How many people did Henry VIII reportedly kill during his reign?
 - A. 12,000
 - B. 35,000
 - C. 72,000
 - D. 120,000

- 2. How long did Charles VI rule France?**
 - A. 12 years
 - B. 25 years
 - C. 42 years
 - D. 60 years
- 3. King Frederick William I created which regiment?**
 - A. The Imperial Guards
 - B. The Potsdam Giants
 - C. The Black Eagles
 - D. The Northern Knights
- 4. Louis XIV reportedly took how many baths as an adult?**
 - A. Zero
 - B. One
 - C. Three
 - D. A monthly bath
- 5. Catherine the Great actually died from:**
 - A. A horse accident
 - B. A stroke
 - C. Poisoning
 - D. Childbirth complications
- 6. Queen Elizabeth I's black teeth came from:**
 - A. Tea staining
 - B. Sugar addiction
 - C. Tobacco use
 - D. A genetic condition
- 7. In what year did Edward II die?**
 - A. 1307
 - B. 1327
 - C. 1357
 - D. 1377
- 8. Peter the Great's 1698 executions targeted:**
 - A. The Boyars
 - B. The Streltsy
 - C. Polish nobles
 - D. Swedish prisoners
- 9. Queen Christina abdicated in:**
 - A. 1640

- B.** 1654
- C.** 1672
- D.** 1689

10. How many wives did Henry VIII have in total?

- A.** Four
- B.** Five
- C.** Six
- D.** Seven

ROUND 4**Quick Fire (10 questions · 1 pt each)**

Short answers — no options. Write from memory.

1. What was the name of Henry VIII's second wife?

Answer:

2. In what year did Queen Elizabeth I die?

Answer:

3. Who was the first Tudor monarch?

Answer:

4. What dynasty preceded the Tudors in England?

Answer:

5. Who succeeded Louis XIV?

Answer:

6. In what year was the French Revolution?

Answer:

7. Who was the last Tsar of Russia?

Answer:

8. What was Marie Antoinette's nationality of birth?

Answer:

9. Which English king signed the Magna Carta?

Answer:

10. Who was the longest-reigning British monarch?

Answer:

ROUND 5**Stump Your Friends! (15 harder questions · 1 pt each)**

The expert round. No mercy.

- 1. King Henry VIII broke from which institution to obtain his first divorce?**
 - A. The Church of England (which he then created)
 - B. The Catholic Church
 - C. The Lutheran Church
 - D. Parliament
- 2. Catherine the Great seized power from which husband?**
 - A. Peter II
 - B. Peter III
 - C. Paul I
 - D. Ivan VI
- 3. The "Sun King" Louis XIV reigned for how many years?**
 - A. 52
 - B. 62
 - C. 72
 - D. 82
- 4. Queen Anne's death in 1714 ended which dynasty?**
 - A. Tudors
 - B. Stuarts
 - C. Hanovers
 - D. Plantagenets
- 5. Tsar Ivan IV is better known as:**
 - A. Ivan the Great
 - B. Ivan the Terrible
 - C. Ivan the Mad
 - D. Ivan the Holy
- 6. King Charles I of England was executed in:**
 - A. 1639
 - B. 1649
 - C. 1659
 - D. 1669
- 7. Which French king was nicknamed "the Spider King" for his manipulation?**
 - A. Louis IX
 - B. Louis XI
 - C. Charles VII

D. Philip IV

8. Queen Mary I of England was nicknamed:

- A. Mary the Pious**
- B. Mary Stuart**
- C. Bloody Mary**
- D. Mary the Just**

9. King Frederick the Great of Prussia's primary opponent was:

- A. Russia**
- B. Austria (Maria Theresa)**
- C. France**
- D. Sweden**

10. How old was Tsar Ivan VI when he was deposed?

- A. Five years old**
- B. Two months old**
- C. Twelve**
- D. Newborn**

11. Which English king lost the Hundred Years War?

- A. Henry V**
- B. Henry VI**
- C. Henry VII**
- D. Edward III**

12. Marie Antoinette was executed in:

- A. 1789**
- B. 1791**
- C. 1793**
- D. 1795**

13. King James VI of Scotland also became:

- A. James I of England**
- B. James II of England**
- C. James III of Spain**
- D. James I of France**

14. Queen Christina of Sweden abdicated her throne to whom?

- A. Her sister**
- B. Her cousin Charles X**
- C. Her son**
- D. The Senate**

15. King George III lost which war as British monarch?

- A. The Napoleonic Wars
- B. The American War of Independence
- C. The Crimean War
- D. The First Boer War

MY SCORE: Q1...../10 Q2...../10 Q3...../10 Q4...../10 Q5...../10
TOTAL: ____/45

CHAPTER NOTE *Royalty is a system that concentrates absolute power in a single bloodline regardless of capability. The result, predictably, was centuries of incompetent, deranged, or genuinely evil people running entire civilisations because their fathers had the previous turn.*

CHAPTER 3 — ANSWER KEY

Round 2 — True or False

1. George III suffered severe mental illness, possibly porphyria. → **TRUE**
2. Henry VIII executed two of his six wives. → **TRUE**
3. Catherine the Great actually died from a horse-related accident. → **FALSE**
4. Charles VI of France believed he was made of glass. → **TRUE**
5. Queen Christina of Sweden converted to Catholicism after abdicating → **TRUE**
6. Frederick William I tried to breed taller soldiers. → **TRUE**
7. Black teeth became a status symbol in Elizabethan England. → **TRUE**
8. Louis XIV bathed regularly throughout his life. → **FALSE**
9. Peter the Great personally executed prisoners by beheading. → **TRUE**
10. Edward II's alleged murder was done in a way to leave no external → **TRUE**

Round 3 — Multiple Choice

1. How many people did Henry VIII reportedly kill during his reign? → **C. 72,000**
2. How long did Charles VI rule France? → **C. 42 years**
3. King Frederick William I created which regiment? → **B. The Potsdam Giants**
4. Louis XIV reportedly took how many baths as an adult? → **B. One**
5. Catherine the Great actually died from: → **B. A stroke**
6. Queen Elizabeth I's black teeth came from: → **B. Sugar addiction**
7. In what year did Edward II die? → **B. 1327**
8. Peter the Great's 1698 executions targeted: → **B. The Streltsy**
9. Queen Christina abdicated in: → **B. 1654**
10. How many wives did Henry VIII have in total? → **C. Six**

Round 4 — Quick Fire

1. What was the name of Henry VIII's second wife? → **Anne Boleyn**
2. In what year did Queen Elizabeth I die? → **1603**
3. Who was the first Tudor monarch? → **Henry VII**
4. What dynasty preceded the Tudors in England? → **The Plantagenets / Yorks (House of York under Richard III)**
5. Who succeeded Louis XIV? → **Louis XV (his great-grandson)**
6. In what year was the French Revolution? → **1789 (started)**
7. Who was the last Tsar of Russia? → **Nicholas II**
8. What was Marie Antoinette's nationality of birth? → **Austrian**
9. Which English king signed the Magna Carta? → **King John**
10. Who was the longest-reigning British monarch? → **Queen Elizabeth II**

Round 5 — Stump Your Friends!

1. King Henry VIII broke from which institution to obtain → **B. The Catholic Church**
2. Catherine the Great seized power from which husband? → **B. Peter III**
3. The "Sun King" Louis XIV reigned for how many years? → **C. 72**
4. Queen Anne's death in 1714 ended which dynasty? → **B. Stuarts**
5. Tsar Ivan IV is better known as: → **B. Ivan the Terrible**
6. King Charles I of England was executed in: → **B. 1649**
7. Which French king was nicknamed "the Spider King" for h → **B. Louis XI**
8. Queen Mary I of England was nicknamed: → **C. Bloody Mary**
9. King Frederick the Great of Prussia's primary opponent → **B. Austria (Maria Theresa)**
10. How old was Tsar Ivan VI when he was deposed? → **B. Two months old**
11. Which English king lost the Hundred Years War? → **B. Henry VI**
12. Marie Antoinette was executed in: → **C. 1793**
13. King James VI of Scotland also became: → **A. James I of England**
14. Queen Christina of Sweden abdicated her throne to whom? → **B. Her cousin Charles X**
15. King George III lost which war as British monarch? → **B. The American War of Independence**

CHAPTER 04 • FORBIDDEN HISTORY

Wars They Don't Want You to Discuss

World War II got 12 chapters in your textbook. The forgotten conflicts — the ones that killed tens of millions and reshaped continents — got a footnote. Or nothing.

ROUND 1 — FACT BOMBS

Read all 10 facts carefully. Your scored rounds follow.

FACT #1

The Taiping Rebellion in China (1850–1864) killed an estimated 20–30 million people — making it the bloodiest civil war in human history. Most Western histories barely mention it.

★ *The deadliest civil war ever fought is missing from most curricula.*

FACT #2

The Second Congo War (1998–2003) killed an estimated 5.4 million people through fighting, famine and disease — yet most people in the West cannot name a single one of its participating armies.

★ *A modern war that killed millions, in living memory, that almost no Western reader has heard of.*

FACT #3

Japan's "Unit 731" was a biological warfare research unit that conducted human experimentation during WWII — vivisection without anaesthesia, deliberate frostbite, infection studies. Many participants escaped trial under American protection in exchange for data.

★ *The Allies prosecuted Nazi doctors but quietly recruited Japanese ones.*

FACT #4

The Bangladesh Liberation War of 1971 included an estimated 300,000 to 3 million deaths and the

systematic mass rape of an estimated 200,000–400,000 Bangladeshi women by Pakistani forces. It is rarely taught in Western schools.

★ *A genocide and mass rape campaign within living memory, virtually absent from Western education.*

FACT #5

The American Civil War killed approximately 750,000 people — more Americans than every other war the United States has ever fought combined.

★ *America has lost more of its own people to itself than to any external enemy.*

FACT #6

During the Soviet–Afghan War (1979–1989), the CIA armed and funded Mujahideen fighters with billions of dollars, including future members of Al-Qaeda. Many of the weapons later returned to be used against American troops.

★ *America armed the people who would attack America fifteen years later.*

FACT #7

The Thirty Years War (1618–1648) killed approximately 8 million people — between 25–40% of the male population of the Holy Roman Empire. Some German regions did not recover their populations until the 19th century.

★ *A war so destructive that some places needed two centuries to recover from it.*

FACT #8

The Korean War (1950–1953) is technically still ongoing — there is no peace treaty, only an armistice. North and South Korea remain at war on paper.

★ *A war that has not ended for 75 years.*

FACT #9

During the Vietnam War, the United States dropped approximately 7 million tons of bombs on Indochina — more than three times the total dropped during all of WWII by all sides combined.

★ *America dropped three WWIIs worth of bombs on Vietnam alone.*

FACT #10

The Mexican-American War (1846–1848) resulted in Mexico losing more than half its territory to the United States — including all of California, Arizona, New Mexico, Nevada, Utah, and parts of Colorado and Wyoming.

★ *One war moved an international border by hundreds of miles.*

ROUND 2**True or False (10 statements · 1 pt each)**

Based on the Fact Bombs above.

1. The Taiping Rebellion was the bloodiest civil war in human history.

TRUE / FALSE

2. The Second Congo War killed approximately 5.4 million people.

TRUE / FALSE

3. Unit 731 conducted vivisection without anaesthesia.

TRUE / FALSE

4. The Bangladesh Liberation War involved no mass rape campaigns.

TRUE / FALSE

5. The American Civil War killed approximately 750,000 people.

TRUE / FALSE

6. CIA-funded Mujahideen weapons were never used against American troops.

TRUE / FALSE

7. The Thirty Years War killed up to 40% of the Holy Roman Empire's male population.

TRUE / FALSE

8. The Korean War officially ended with a peace treaty in 1953.

TRUE / FALSE

9. America dropped more bombs on Vietnam than were dropped in all of WWII.

TRUE / FALSE

10. Mexico lost more than half its territory in the Mexican-American War.

TRUE / FALSE

ROUND 3**Could You Have Guessed? (10 questions · 1 pt each)**

Four options — choose the correct one.

1. How many people did the Taiping Rebellion kill?

A. 5–10 million

- B. 10–15 million
 - C. 20–30 million
 - D. 50 million
- 2. When was the Second Congo War?**
- A. 1968–1972
 - B. 1985–1993
 - C. 1998–2003
 - D. 2008–2013
- 3. How many bombs did the US drop on Indochina compared to WWII total?**
- A. Half as many
 - B. The same
 - C. Three times more
 - D. Ten times more
- 4. How long has the Korean War technically been ongoing?**
- A. ~50 years
 - B. ~65 years
 - C. ~75 years
 - D. It officially ended in 1953
- 5. What was Unit 731?**
- A. A US Army intelligence unit
 - B. A Japanese biological warfare unit
 - C. A Soviet special forces unit
 - D. A Nazi medical division
- 6. How many Americans died in the American Civil War?**
- A. 250,000
 - B. 500,000
 - C. 750,000
 - D. 1.5 million
- 7. The Mexican-American War transferred which states to the US?**
- A. Texas only
 - B. California, Arizona, New Mexico and parts of others
 - C. All Mexican territory
 - D. Just Florida
- 8. Mass rape estimates during the Bangladesh Liberation War range:**

- A. 1,000–10,000
- B. 50,000–100,000
- C. 200,000–400,000
- D. Over 1 million

9. Some German regions did not recover from the Thirty Years War until:

- A. 1700
- B. 1750
- C. The 19th century
- D. The 20th century

10. CIA-armed Mujahideen included future members of which group?

- A. Hezbollah
- B. Al-Qaeda
- C. ISIS
- D. Hamas

ROUND 4**Quick Fire (10 questions · 1 pt each)**

Short answers — no options. Write from memory.

- 1.** In what year did WWII end in Europe?

Answer:

- 2.** Who was the leader of the Soviet Union during WWII?

Answer:

- 3.** In what year did the Vietnam War end?

Answer:

- 4.** What event triggered WWI?

Answer:

- 5.** What was the codename for the D-Day invasion?

Answer:

- 6.** What treaty ended WWI?

Answer:

- 7.** Who was the British Prime Minister during most of WWII?

Answer:

- 8.** What was the largest tank battle in history?

Answer:

- 9.** In what year did the Korean War begin?

Answer:

- 10.** What was Operation Barbarossa?

Answer:

ROUND 5**Stump Your Friends! (15 harder questions · 1 pt each)**

The expert round. No mercy.

- 1. The Cuban Missile Crisis lasted approximately how long?**
 - A. One day
 - B. 13 days
 - C. One month
 - D. Three months
- 2. The longest war in modern history (officially) is:**
 - A. The American War in Afghanistan
 - B. The Korean War
 - C. The Sri Lankan Civil War
 - D. The Colombian conflict
- 3. How many people died in the Iraq War (2003–2011)?**
 - A. 50,000
 - B. 100,000
 - C. Over 200,000 (various estimates)
 - D. Over 1 million
- 4. The Yom Kippur War (1973) primarily involved:**
 - A. Israel against Egypt and Syria
 - B. Israel against all Arab states
 - C. Egypt against Sudan
 - D. Iraq against Iran
- 5. How many soldiers participated in the Battle of Stalingrad?**
 - A. 500,000
 - B. 1 million
 - C. 2 million
 - D. Over 2.2 million
- 6. The British "scorched earth" policy in the Boer War created:**
 - A. Massive infrastructure damage
 - B. Concentration camps where ~28,000 Boer civilians died
 - C. Millions of refugees
 - D. Lasting environmental damage
- 7. The Battle of Verdun in WWI is notable because:**
 - A. It ended in days
 - B. It was the longest battle, lasting 10 months with ~700,000 casualties
 - C. It was the smallest WWI battle

- D. It was won decisively by France
- 8. The "Christmas Truce" of WWI occurred in:**
- A. 1914
 - B. 1915
 - C. 1916
 - D. 1917
- 9. How many Soviet soldiers died in WWII (estimated)?**
- A. Under 5 million
 - B. 8–11 million
 - C. 15–17 million
 - D. 20–25 million
- 10. The Spanish Civil War occurred in:**
- A. 1926–1929
 - B. 1936–1939
 - C. 1946–1949
 - D. 1956–1959
- 11. The Vietnam War officially involved which US president's 1973 withdrawal?**
- A. Johnson
 - B. Nixon
 - C. Ford
 - D. Carter
- 12. The Falklands War (1982) was fought between:**
- A. UK and Argentina
 - B. UK and Spain
 - C. US and Cuba
 - D. UK and Chile
- 13. How many died in the Rwandan Genocide?**
- A. ~100,000
 - B. ~300,000
 - C. ~800,000
 - D. Over 2 million
- 14. The Nuremberg Trials prosecuted approximately how many defendants?**
- A. 12
 - B. 24
 - C. 100
 - D. Over 200

15. The Treaty of Brest-Litovsk ended which conflict?

- A. WWI for Russia
- B. The Russian Civil War
- C. The Russo-Japanese War
- D. The Crimean War

MY SCORE: R1:____/10 R2:____/10 R3:____/10 R4:____/10
TOTAL:____/45

CHAPTER NOTE Wars are remembered selectively. The conflicts that get textbook chapters tend to be the ones the winners lived to write about. The wars that killed the most people often vanish from memory entirely, which is itself a form of historical erasure.

CHAPTER 4 — ANSWER KEY

Round 2 — True or False

1. The Taiping Rebellion was the bloodiest civil war in human history → **TRUE**
2. The Second Congo War killed approximately 5.4 million people. → **TRUE**
3. Unit 731 conducted vivisection without anaesthesia. → **TRUE**
4. The Bangladesh Liberation War involved no mass rape campaigns. → **FALSE**
5. The American Civil War killed approximately 750,000 people. → **TRUE**
6. CIA-funded Mujahideen weapons were never used against American troops → **FALSE**
7. The Thirty Years War killed up to 40% of the Holy Roman Empire's → **TRUE**
8. The Korean War officially ended with a peace treaty in 1953. → **FALSE**
9. America dropped more bombs on Vietnam than were dropped in all of → **TRUE**
10. Mexico lost more than half its territory in the Mexican-American → **TRUE**

Round 3 — Multiple Choice

1. How many people did the Taiping Rebellion kill? → **C. 20–30 million**
2. When was the Second Congo War? → **C. 1998–2003**
3. How many bombs did the US drop on Indochina compared to → **C. Three times more**
4. How long has the Korean War technically been ongoing? → **C. ~75 years**
5. What was Unit 731? → **B. A Japanese biological warfare unit**
6. How many Americans died in the American Civil War? → **C. 750,000**
7. The Mexican-American War transferred which states to the US? → **B. California, Arizona, New Mexico and parts of others**
8. Mass rape estimates during the Bangladesh Liberation War → **C. 200,000–400,000**
9. Some German regions did not recover from the Thirty Years War → **C. The 19th century**
10. CIA-armed Mujahideen included future members of which group? → **B. Al-Qaeda**

Round 4 — Quick Fire

1. In what year did WWII end in Europe? → **1945 (May)**
2. Who was the leader of the Soviet Union during WWII? → **Joseph Stalin**
3. In what year did the Vietnam War end? → **1975**
4. What event triggered WWI? → **The assassination of Archduke Franz Ferdinand**
5. What was the codename for the D-Day invasion? → **Operation Overlord**
6. What treaty ended WWI? → **The Treaty of Versailles (1919)**

7. Who was the British Prime Minister during most of WWII? → **Winston Churchill**
8. What was the largest tank battle in history? → **The Battle of Kursk (1943)**
9. In what year did the Korean War begin? → **1950**
10. What was Operation Barbarossa? → **Germany's invasion of the Soviet Union (1941)**

Round 5 — Stump Your Friends!

1. The Cuban Missile Crisis lasted approximately how long? → **B. 13 days**
2. The longest war in modern history (officially) is: → **A. The American War in Afghanistan**
3. How many people died in the Iraq War (2003–2011)? → **C. Over 200,000 (various estimates)**
4. The Yom Kippur War (1973) primarily involved: → **A. Israel against Egypt and Syria**
5. How many soldiers participated in the Battle of Staling → **D. Over 2.2 million**
6. The British "scorched earth" policy in the Boer War cre → **B. Concentration camps where ~28,000 Boer civilians died**
7. The Battle of Verdun in WWI is notable because: → **B. It was the longest battle, lasting 10 months with ~700,000 casualties**
8. The "Christmas Truce" of WWI occurred in: → **A. 1914**
9. How many Soviet soldiers died in WWII (estimated)? → **B. 8–11 million**
10. The Spanish Civil War occurred in: → **B. 1936–1939**
11. The Vietnam War officially involved which US president? → **B. Nixon**
12. The Falklands War (1982) was fought between: → **A. UK and Argentina**
13. How many died in the Rwandan Genocide? → **C. ~800,000**
14. The Nuremberg Trials prosecuted approximately how many → **B. 24**
15. The Treaty of Brest-Litovsk ended which conflict? → **A. WWI for Russia**

CHAPTER 05 • FORBIDDEN HISTORY

Banned Books, Suppressed Knowledge & Censored Truths

For most of recorded history, the easiest way to silence an idea was to burn the book that contained it. The list of works once banned reads like a syllabus of human civilisation.

ROUND 1 — FACT BOMBS

Read all 10 facts carefully. Your scored rounds follow.

FACT #1

The burning of the Library of Alexandria did not happen in a single dramatic fire. The library declined gradually over centuries through neglect, budget cuts, multiple smaller fires, and political turmoil. The dramatic burning is largely a myth.

★ *History's most famous catastrophe was actually a slow bureaucratic decline.*

FACT #2

In 1933, German Nazi students burned over 25,000 books considered "un-German" — works by Einstein, Freud, Hemingway, Kafka, and Jewish authors. Heinrich Heine had warned a century earlier: "Where they burn books, they will end up burning people."

★ *A 19th-century poet predicted the 20th century's worst horror.*

FACT #3

China's Qin dynasty Emperor Qin Shi Huang ordered the burning of all books critical of his regime in 213 BC, and reportedly buried 460 Confucian scholars alive in 212 BC for refusing to comply.

★ *A 2,000-year-old precedent for state-sanctioned censorship.*

FACT #4

The Catholic Church's "Index Librorum Prohibitorum" (Index of Forbidden Books) listed banned books from 1559 until 1966. It included works by Galileo, Descartes, Hume, Locke, Voltaire, Sartre, and many others. The Index was finally abolished only 60 years ago.

★ *A book ban list that survived into living memory.*

FACT #5

In Stalin's Soviet Union, photographs were systematically altered to remove people who fell out of political favour. Entire individuals were erased from photos with airbrushes — predating Photoshop by 70 years.

★ *The original "fake news" was state photo manipulation in the 1930s.*

FACT #6

The Pentagon Papers (1971) revealed that successive US administrations had systematically lied to Congress and the public about the Vietnam War. Daniel Ellsberg, who leaked them, faced 115 years in prison. Charges were dropped due to government misconduct.

★ *The US government tried to imprison the man who proved it had been lying.*

FACT #7

In 1976, NASA destroyed all original tapes of the Apollo 11 Moon landing as part of routine record management. The tapes have never been recovered. We have only lower-quality copies of one of humanity's most important moments.

★ *NASA accidentally lost the original footage of mankind's greatest achievement.*

FACT #8

The "Memory Hole" in George Orwell's 1984 was directly inspired by Soviet practice. Stalin's government employed thousands of full-time workers solely to alter newspapers, photographs, encyclopedias, and government records to match the current party line.

★ *A dystopian fiction that was simply Soviet daily reality.*

FACT #9

Ancient Egyptian Pharaoh Akhenaten's religious revolution (worship of one sun god, Aten) was so thoroughly erased after his death (1336 BC) that Egypt nearly forgot he existed. His name was scratched off all monuments.

★ *A pharaoh's entire reign deliberately removed from history by his successors.*

FACT #10

The Chinese government has banned, blocked, or suppressed information about the 1989 Tiananmen Square massacre to such a degree that an estimated majority of Chinese citizens under 40 have never heard of it.

★ *A massacre erased so completely that most people in its country don't know it happened.*

ROUND 2**True or False (10 statements · 1 pt each)**

Based on the Fact Bombs above.

- 1.** The Library of Alexandria was destroyed in a single dramatic fire.

TRUE / FALSE

- 2.** Nazi students burned over 25,000 books in 1933.

TRUE / FALSE

- 3.** Heinrich Heine warned about book-burning before the Nazi era.

TRUE / FALSE

- 4.** Qin Shi Huang reportedly buried Confucian scholars alive.

TRUE / FALSE

- 5.** The Index of Forbidden Books was abolished in 1966.

TRUE / FALSE

- 6.** Stalin's government did not alter historical photographs.

TRUE / FALSE

- 7.** The Pentagon Papers proved US officials lied about the Vietnam War.

TRUE / FALSE

- 8.** NASA preserved all original Apollo 11 footage.

TRUE / FALSE

- 9.** Akhenaten's religious revolution was deliberately erased after his death.

TRUE / FALSE

- 10.** Information about Tiananmen Square is freely available in China.

TRUE / FALSE

ROUND 3**Could You Have Guessed? (10 questions · 1 pt each)**

Four options — choose the correct one.

- 1. In what year did the Index Librorum Prohibitorum end?**

A. 1900

B. 1933

- C. 1966
 - D. 1990
- 2. Daniel Ellsberg faced how many years for the Pentagon Papers?**
- A. 25
 - B. 55
 - C. 115
 - D. Death penalty
- 3. In what year did the Tiananmen Square massacre occur?**
- A. 1979
 - B. 1989
 - C. 1999
 - D. 2009
- 4. Qin Shi Huang reportedly buried how many scholars alive?**
- A. 46
 - B. 460
 - C. 4,600
 - D. 46,000
- 5. Akhenaten's reign ended approximately when?**
- A. 1500 BC
 - B. 1336 BC
 - C. 1100 BC
 - D. 800 BC
- 6. How many books did Nazi students burn in 1933?**
- A. Over 5,000
 - B. Over 15,000
 - C. Over 25,000
 - D. Over 100,000
- 7. How many years before WWII did Heinrich Heine make his warning?**
- A. 25 years
 - B. 50 years
 - C. 100 years
 - D. 150 years
- 8. NASA destroyed Apollo 11 original tapes in approximately:**

- A. 1969
 - B. 1972
 - C. 1976
 - D. 1981
- 9. The Library of Alexandria declined over how long?**
- A. One day
 - B. Months
 - C. Decades
 - D. Centuries
- 10. Qin Shi Huang ordered book burning in:**
- A. 213 BC
 - B. 165 BC
 - C. 100 BC
 - D. 50 BC

ROUND 4**Quick Fire (10 questions · 1 pt each)**

Short answers — no options. Write from memory.

- 1.** Who wrote 1984?

Answer:

- 2.** In what year was the Index Librorum Prohibitorum first published?

Answer:

- 3.** Who first proved heliocentrism?

Answer:

- 4.** What was Galileo's punishment for supporting heliocentrism?

Answer:

- 5.** Who was the chief Soviet propaganda official under Stalin?

Answer:

- 6.** What was the Stasi?

Answer:

- 7.** Who wrote Fahrenheit 451?

Answer:

- 8.** In what year did Tiananmen Square occur?

Answer:

- 9.** Who created the original "Memory Hole" concept?

Answer:

- 10.** What religion did Akhenaten introduce to Egypt?

Answer:

ROUND 5**Stump Your Friends! (15 harder questions · 1 pt each)**

The expert round. No mercy.

- 1. The Pentagon Papers were published primarily by which newspaper?**
 - A. The Washington Post
 - B. The New York Times
 - C. The Los Angeles Times
 - D. The Chicago Tribune
- 2. Galileo's "Dialogue Concerning the Two Chief World Systems" was banned in what year?**
 - A. 1615
 - B. 1632
 - C. 1664
 - D. 1700
- 3. Which Roman Emperor commissioned the suppression of pagan literature?**
 - A. Constantine
 - B. Theodosius
 - C. Justinian
 - D. Charlemagne
- 4. The Berlin Book Burning of 1933 was attended by which Nazi official?**
 - A. Hitler
 - B. Himmler
 - C. Goebbels
 - D. Hess
- 5. In Soviet Russia, which scientific theory was suppressed for political reasons?**
 - A. Quantum mechanics
 - B. Genetics (Lysenkoism replaced Mendelian genetics)
 - C. Theory of relativity
 - D. Plate tectonics
- 6. The CIA program MKUltra researched what?**
 - A. Hypnosis
 - B. Mind control through drugs and torture
 - C. Telepathy
 - D. Remote viewing
- 7. How many years was George Orwell's 1984 banned in the Soviet Union?**

- A. Until Stalin's death
 - B. Until 1968
 - C. Until 1990
 - D. It was never banned
- 8. The Vatican's Secret Archives was renamed in 2019 to:**
- A. Vatican Historical Archives
 - B. Apostolic Archive
 - C. Vatican Confidential Archive
 - D. The Holy Archives
- 9. The "Streisand effect" describes:**
- A. Increasing attention by trying to suppress information
 - B. Famous people's influence on culture
 - C. Media manipulation by celebrities
 - D. A propaganda technique
- 10. In Iran, the satellite TV channel BBC Persian is:**
- A. State-sponsored
 - B. Officially blocked
 - C. Required viewing
 - D. Privately owned
- 11. How many websites are blocked in China (estimated)?**
- A. Hundreds
 - B. Thousands
 - C. Tens of thousands
 - D. Hundreds of thousands
- 12. In Saudi Arabia, what year did women legally gain the right to drive?**
- A. 2008
 - B. 2013
 - C. 2018
 - D. 2022
- 13. The "Streisand effect" was named after:**
- A. Barbra Streisand's attempt to suppress aerial photos of her home
 - B. Her opposition to a 1990s movie
 - C. Her political views
 - D. Her photographic copyright lawsuits
- 14. The Cypherpunks movement promoted:**

- A. Strong cryptography to defeat surveillance
- B. Government control of the internet
- C. Open-source software
- D. Decentralised governance

15. The Vatican Secret Archives were declassified for which Pope's era in 2020?

- A. John XXIII
- B. John Paul II
- C. Pius XII
- D. Benedict XV

MY SCORE:

0/20

100/100

100/100

100/100

100

TOTAL: ____/45

CHAPTER NOTE *Suppression of knowledge has always been the first move of those losing an argument. The historical record shows that censorship rarely succeeds in the long term — but it can erase enough that we cannot fully reconstruct what was lost. Some books and ideas are gone forever.*

CHAPTER 5 — ANSWER KEY

Round 2 — True or False

1. The Library of Alexandria was destroyed in a single dramatic fire → **FALSE**
2. Nazi students burned over 25,000 books in 1933. → **TRUE**
3. Heinrich Heine warned about book-burning before the Nazi era. → **TRUE**
4. Qin Shi Huang reportedly buried Confucian scholars alive. → **TRUE**
5. The Index of Forbidden Books was abolished in 1966. → **TRUE**
6. Stalin's government did not alter historical photographs. → **FALSE**
7. The Pentagon Papers proved US officials lied about the Vietnam War → **TRUE**
8. NASA preserved all original Apollo 11 footage. → **FALSE**
9. Akhenaten's religious revolution was deliberately erased after his death → **TRUE**
10. Information about Tiananmen Square is freely available in China. → **FALSE**

Round 3 — Multiple Choice

1. In what year did the Index Librorum Prohibitorum end? → **C. 1966**
2. Daniel Ellsberg faced how many years for the Pentagon Papers? → **C. 115**
3. In what year did the Tiananmen Square massacre occur? → **B. 1989**
4. Qin Shi Huang reportedly buried how many scholars alive? → **B. 460**
5. Akhenaten's reign ended approximately when? → **B. 1336 BC**
6. How many books did Nazi students burn in 1933? → **C. Over 25,000**
7. How many years before WWII did Heinrich Heine make his prediction? → **C. 100 years**
8. NASA destroyed Apollo 11 original tapes in approximately? → **C. 1976**
9. The Library of Alexandria declined over how long? → **D. Centuries**
10. Qin Shi Huang ordered book burning in: → **A. 213 BC**

Round 4 — Quick Fire

1. Who wrote 1984? → **George Orwell**
2. In what year was the Index Librorum Prohibitorum first published? → **1559**
3. Who first proved heliocentrism? → **Copernicus (and confirmed by Galileo)**
4. What was Galileo's punishment for supporting heliocentrism? → **House arrest for life by the Catholic Church**
5. Who was the chief Soviet propaganda official under Stalin? → **Andrei Zhdanov (or Mikhail Suslov)**
6. What was the Stasi? → **East Germany's secret police and intelligence agency**
7. Who wrote Fahrenheit 451? → **Ray Bradbury**
8. In what year did Tiananmen Square occur? → **1989**
9. Who created the original "Memory Hole" concept? → **George Orwell (in his novel 1984)**

10. What religion did Akhenaten introduce to Egypt? → **Atenism (sun-disc monotheism)**

Round 5 — Stump Your Friends!

- 1.** The Pentagon Papers were published primarily by which n → **B. The New York Times**
- 2.** Galileo's "Dialogue Concerning the Two Chief World Syst → **B. 1632**
- 3.** Which Roman Emperor commissioned the suppression of pag → **B. Theodosius**
- 4.** The Berlin Book Burning of 1933 was attended by which N → **C. Goebbels**
- 5.** In Soviet Russia, which scientific theory was suppress → **B. Genetics (Lysenkoism replaced Mendelian genetics)**
- 6.** The CIA program MKUltra researched what? → **B. Mind control through drugs and torture**
- 7.** How many years was George Orwell's 1984 banned in the S → **C. Until 1990**
- 8.** The Vatican's Secret Archives was renamed in 2019 to: → **B. Apostolic Archive**
- 9.** The "Streisand effect" describes: → **A. Increasing attention by trying to suppress information**
- 10.** In Iran, the satellite TV channel BBC Persian is: → **B. Officially blocked**
- 11.** How many websites are blocked in China (estimated)? → **D. Hundreds of thousands**
- 12.** In Saudi Arabia, what year did women legally gain the r → **C. 2018**
- 13.** The "Streisand effect" was named after: → **A. Barbra Streisand's attempt to suppress aerial photos of her home**
- 14.** The Cypherpunks movement promoted: → **A. Strong cryptography to defeat surveillance**
- 15.** The Vatican Secret Archives were declassified for which → **C. Pius XII**

CHAPTER 06 • FORBIDDEN HISTORY

Plagues, Pandemics & Hidden Death Tolls

COVID-19 felt unprecedented. It was not. Diseases have repeatedly remade civilisation, and the death tolls of the past dwarf anything modern medicine has had to handle.

ROUND 1 — FACT BOMBS

Read all 10 facts carefully. Your scored rounds follow.

FACT #1

The 1918 Spanish Flu killed an estimated 50 million people worldwide — more than both world wars combined. Despite the name, it almost certainly did not originate in Spain. Spain was simply the first country to report it openly because it wasn't at war and had no censorship.

★ *A pandemic named for the only country honest enough to report it.*

FACT #2

The Antonine Plague (165–180 AD) — possibly smallpox — may have killed up to 25% of the Roman Empire's population, including Emperor Marcus Aurelius. Some historians argue it was the beginning of Rome's long decline.

★ *A plague that may have killed Rome itself.*

FACT #3

During the European colonisation of the Americas, an estimated 56 million indigenous people died — approximately 90% of the pre-Columbian population — primarily through European diseases like smallpox, measles, and influenza. This collapse has been linked to the cooling of the global climate (the "Little Ice Age").

★ *A genocide so massive it altered Earth's climate.*

FACT #4

Smallpox killed approximately 300 million people in the 20th century alone before being declared eradicated in 1980 — making it the deadliest disease in human history.

★ *A single disease killed more people in one century than two world wars and the Spanish Flu combined.*

FACT #5

The Plague of Justinian (541–549 AD) killed an estimated 25–50 million people — possibly 50% of the Byzantine Empire's population. It was caused by the same bacterium as the Black Death (*Yersinia pestis*), some 800 years earlier.

★ *The same disease devastated humanity twice, 800 years apart.*

FACT #6

The 1957 Asian Flu pandemic killed an estimated 1.1 million people globally. The 1968 Hong Kong Flu killed approximately 1 million. Both are largely forgotten in popular memory.

★ *Two million people killed by pandemics nobody remembers.*

FACT #7

Tuberculosis killed approximately 1 in 7 of all people who ever lived in Europe and North America between 1600 and 1800 — a slow, lingering disease that defined an entire era of literature and music. It killed Chopin, Keats, the Brontë sisters, Kafka, and Orwell.

★ *A disease so common it shaped an entire literary tradition.*

FACT #8

The 1854 Broad Street cholera outbreak in London killed 616 people in a small London neighbourhood. Dr John Snow traced it to a single contaminated water pump — founding modern epidemiology in the process.

★ *Modern epidemiology was invented by a man who removed a pump handle.*

FACT #9

HIV/AIDS has killed an estimated 40 million people since being identified in 1981. The virus likely crossed

from chimpanzees to humans in West Africa around 1920 — but went undetected for over 60 years.

★ *A pandemic that hid in plain sight for six decades before anyone noticed.*

FACT #10

The 14th-century Black Death may have inadvertently strengthened the survivors' descendants. Genetic research suggests certain immune system variants common in modern Europeans were positively selected for by surviving the plague.

★ *You may be alive today because your ancestor survived the Black Death.*

ROUND 2**True or False (10 statements · 1 pt each)**

Based on the Fact Bombs above.

1. The 1918 Spanish Flu killed approximately 50 million people.
TRUE / FALSE
2. The Spanish Flu actually originated in Spain.
TRUE / FALSE
3. The Antonine Plague may have killed up to 25% of Rome's population.
TRUE / FALSE
4. European colonisation killed approximately 90% of the pre-Columbian indigenous population.
TRUE / FALSE
5. Smallpox killed about 300 million people in the 20th century.
TRUE / FALSE
6. The Plague of Justinian and the Black Death were caused by different bacteria.
TRUE / FALSE
7. TB killed approximately 1 in 7 Europeans between 1600 and 1800.
TRUE / FALSE
8. John Snow's 1854 cholera investigation founded modern epidemiology.
TRUE / FALSE
9. HIV crossed from chimpanzees to humans in the 1980s.
TRUE / FALSE
10. The Black Death may have positively selected for certain immune variants in modern Europeans.
TRUE / FALSE

ROUND 3**Could You Have Guessed? (10 questions · 1 pt each)**

Four options — choose the correct one.

1. **How many people did the 1918 Spanish Flu kill?**
A. 10 million
B. 25 million

- C. 50 million
 - D. 100 million
- 2. Why was the 1918 pandemic named "Spanish"?**
- A. It started in Spain
 - B. Spain was the only country to report it openly
 - C. It killed mostly Spaniards
 - D. It was named after a Spanish doctor
- 3. How many indigenous people died in the European colonisation?**
- A. 10 million
 - B. 25 million
 - C. 56 million
 - D. 100 million
- 4. Smallpox was officially declared eradicated in:**
- A. 1965
 - B. 1972
 - C. 1980
 - D. 1996
- 5. The Plague of Justinian killed approximately:**
- A. 1-5 million
 - B. 5-15 million
 - C. 15-25 million
 - D. 25-50 million
- 6. How many people did the 1957 Asian Flu kill?**
- A. 100,000
 - B. 500,000
 - C. 1.1 million
 - D. 5 million
- 7. What fraction of Europeans died from TB between 1600-1800?**
- A. 1 in 100
 - B. 1 in 50
 - C. 1 in 20
 - D. 1 in 7
- 8. How did Dr Snow stop the 1854 cholera outbreak?**
- A. Quarantine
 - B. Boiling water mandate
 - C. Removing a contaminated pump handle

D. Burning infected houses

9. HIV likely crossed to humans approximately when?

- A. Around 1900**
- B. Around 1920**
- C. Around 1950**
- D. Around 1980**

10. How many people has HIV/AIDS killed since 1981?

- A. 10 million**
- B. 25 million**
- C. 40 million**
- D. 70 million**

ROUND 4**Quick Fire (10 questions · 1 pt each)**

Short answers — no options. Write from memory.

1. What bacterium causes the bubonic plague?

Answer:

2. Who discovered penicillin?

Answer:

3. In what year was the COVID-19 pandemic declared?

Answer:

4. What disease did Edward Jenner develop a vaccine for?

Answer:

5. In what year did the AIDS epidemic become public knowledge?

Answer:

6. What is the WHO?

Answer:

7. What was the cause of cholera as identified by John Snow?

Answer:

8. In what year did the Black Death first reach Europe?

Answer:

9. Who developed the polio vaccine?

Answer:

10. What is "Patient Zero" in epidemiology?

Answer:

ROUND 5**Stump Your Friends! (15 harder questions · 1 pt each)**

The expert round. No mercy.

- 1. The 14th-century Black Death originated in which region?**
 - A. North Africa
 - B. Southern Europe
 - C. Central Asia
 - D. India
- 2. How many died in the 1665 Great Plague of London?**
 - A. 10,000
 - B. 50,000
 - C. 100,000
 - D. 500,000
- 3. The 1854 cholera epidemic struck which London neighbourhood?**
 - A. Whitechapel
 - B. Soho (Broad Street)
 - C. Bermondsey
 - D. Limehouse
- 4. Who first identified the bacterium that causes the plague?**
 - A. Robert Koch
 - B. Louis Pasteur
 - C. Alexandre Yersin
 - D. Joseph Lister
- 5. The "Spanish Flu" originated possibly in:**
 - A. Mexico
 - B. China
 - C. Kansas, USA
 - D. France
- 6. When did the Ebola virus first emerge?**
 - A. 1976
 - B. 1986
 - C. 1996
 - D. 2006
- 7. How many died in the 2014 West African Ebola outbreak?**
 - A. 1,000
 - B. 5,000
 - C. 11,000

- D. 50,000
- 8. Tuberculosis is caused by which microorganism?**
- A. A virus
 - B. A fungus
 - C. A bacterium (*Mycobacterium tuberculosis*)
 - D. A parasite
- 9. Vaccination was preceded by which earlier practice?**
- A. Bloodletting
 - B. Variolation (deliberate infection with mild smallpox)
 - C. Quarantine
 - D. Herbal medicine
- 10. How many polio cases were there in the US peak year (1952)?**
- A. Under 10,000
 - B. Around 21,000
 - C. Around 58,000
 - D. Over 100,000
- 11. The 1976 swine flu vaccination programme was halted because:**
- A. Vaccine shortage
 - B. Cases of Guillain-Barré syndrome
 - C. The pandemic never materialised
 - D. Side effects emerged
- 12. How many people contracted COVID-19 worldwide by end of 2024?**
- A. 100 million
 - B. 300 million
 - C. Over 700 million confirmed
 - D. Over 2 billion
- 13. The first SARS outbreak occurred in:**
- A. 1999
 - B. 2003
 - C. 2007
 - D. 2012
- 14. Yellow fever is transmitted by:**
- A. Rat fleas
 - B. Mosquitoes (*Aedes aegypti*)
 - C. Contaminated water

D. Direct contact

15. Henrietta Lacks' cells (HeLa) revolutionised research because they:

- A. Survived freezing
- B. Were infinitely reproducible in lab conditions
- C. Were resistant to all viruses
- D. Were the first human cells to be photographed

MY SCORE: Q1 _____ Q2 _____ Q3 _____ Q4 _____ Q5 _____
TOTAL: ____/45

CHAPTER NOTE *Disease has shaped human history more decisively than any general or king. The scale of pandemic mortality is genuinely difficult to grasp — and the survivors writing the history books rarely give it the chapters it deserves.*

CHAPTER 6 — ANSWER KEY

Round 2 — True or False

1. The 1918 Spanish Flu killed approximately 50 million people. → **TRUE**
2. The Spanish Flu actually originated in Spain. → **FALSE**
3. The Antonine Plague may have killed up to 25% of Rome's population → **TRUE**
4. European colonisation killed approximately 90% of the pre-Columbi → **TRUE**
5. Smallpox killed about 300 million people in the 20th century. → **TRUE**
6. The Plague of Justinian and the Black Death were caused by differ → **FALSE**
7. TB killed approximately 1 in 7 Europeans between 1600 and 1800. → **TRUE**
8. John Snow's 1854 cholera investigation founded modern epidemiology → **TRUE**
9. HIV crossed from chimpanzees to humans in the 1980s. → **FALSE**
10. The Black Death may have positively selected for certain immune variants → **TRUE**

Round 3 — Multiple Choice

1. How many people did the 1918 Spanish Flu kill? → **C. 50 million**
2. Why was the 1918 pandemic named "Spanish"? → **B. Spain was the only country to report it openly**
3. How many indigenous people died in the European colonies → **C. 56 million**
4. Smallpox was officially declared eradicated in: → **C. 1980**
5. The Plague of Justinian killed approximately: → **D. 25-50 million**
6. How many people did the 1957 Asian Flu kill? → **C. 1.1 million**
7. What fraction of Europeans died from TB between 1600-18 → **D. 1 in 7**
8. How did Dr Snow stop the 1854 cholera outbreak? → **C. Removing a contaminated pump handle**
9. HIV likely crossed to humans approximately when? → **B. Around 1920**
10. How many people has HIV/AIDS killed since 1981? → **C. 40 million**

Round 4 — Quick Fire

1. What bacterium causes the bubonic plague? → **Yersinia pestis**
2. Who discovered penicillin? → **Alexander Fleming**
3. In what year was the COVID-19 pandemic declared? → **2020**
4. What disease did Edward Jenner develop a vaccine for? → **Smallpox**
5. In what year did the AIDS epidemic become public knowledge? → **1981**
6. What is the WHO? → **World Health Organization**
7. What was the cause of cholera as identified by John Snow? → **Contaminated water**
8. In what year did the Black Death first reach Europe? → **1347**
9. Who developed the polio vaccine? → **Jonas Salk**

10. What is "Patient Zero" in epidemiology? → **The first identified person infected with a disease**

Round 5 — Stump Your Friends!

- 1.** The 14th-century Black Death originated in which region → **C. Central Asia**
- 2.** How many died in the 1665 Great Plague of London? → **C. 100,000**
- 3.** The 1854 cholera epidemic struck which London neighbour → **B. Soho (Broad Street)**
- 4.** Who first identified the bacterium that causes the plag → **C. Alexandre Yersin**
- 5.** The "Spanish Flu" originated possibly in: → **C. Kansas, USA**
- 6.** When did the Ebola virus first emerge? → **A. 1976**
- 7.** How many died in the 2014 West African Ebola outbreak? → **C. 11,000**
- 8.** Tuberculosis is caused by which microorganism? → **C. A bacterium (Mycobacterium tuberculosis)**
- 9.** Vaccination was preceded by which earlier practice? → **B. Variolation (deliberate infection with mild smallpox)**
- 10.** How many polio cases were there in the US peak year (19 → **C. Around 58,000**
- 11.** The 1976 swine flu vaccination programme was halted bec → **B. Cases of Guillain-Barré syndrome**
- 12.** How many people contracted COVID-19 worldwide by end of → **C. Over 700 million confirmed**
- 13.** The first SARS outbreak occurred in: → **B. 2003**
- 14.** Yellow fever is transmitted by: → **B. Mosquitoes (Aedes aegypti)**
- 15.** Henrietta Lacks' cells (HeLa) revolutionised research b → **B. Were infinitely reproducible in lab conditions**

CHAPTER 07 • FORBIDDEN HISTORY

Lost Civilisations & Vanished Peoples

Entire civilisations have risen, dominated their regions, and disappeared so completely that until recently we did not know they existed. Some left no language. Some left no name we can pronounce.

ROUND 1 — FACT BOMBS

Read all 10 facts carefully. Your scored rounds follow.

FACT #1

The Indus Valley Civilisation (c. 3300–1300 BC) covered an area larger than ancient Egypt and Mesopotamia combined, had population estimates of over 5 million, possessed writing — and we still cannot read their script.

★ *A civilisation larger than its contemporaries that we cannot read.*

FACT #2

Göbekli Tepe in Turkey is approximately 11,000–12,000 years old — making it 7,000 years older than Stonehenge and 6,000 years older than the Pyramids. It was built by hunter-gatherers, before agriculture existed.

★ *A monument older than civilisation itself.*

FACT #3

The Sea Peoples destroyed multiple Bronze Age civilisations around 1200 BC — the Hittites, the Mycenaean Greeks, parts of Egypt — in what historians call the "Late Bronze Age Collapse." We still don't know who they were.

★ *A mystery people who ended an entire era.*

FACT #4

The Khmer Empire (802–1431 AD) of Southeast Asia built Angkor — the largest pre-industrial city in the world, with a population over 750,000. It was abandoned and reclaimed by jungle, only to be "rediscovered" by Europeans in 1860.

★ *A city of three-quarters of a million people, completely lost to vegetation.*

FACT #5

The Olmec civilisation of Mesoamerica (1200–400 BC) created colossal stone heads weighing up to 40 tonnes carved from basalt that had to be transported over 80 kilometres without wheels or pack animals. We don't know how.

★ *An ancient logistical impossibility we still cannot explain.*

FACT #6

The Nabataean Kingdom carved Petra entirely from rock — a civilisation that controlled the spice trade for centuries. They vanished from history after a 363 AD earthquake destroyed their water management system.

★ *A kingdom destroyed by plumbing failure.*

FACT #7

The Cucuteni-Trypillian culture (5500–2750 BC) in modern Ukraine and Romania built cities of up to 15,000 people — at a time when most Europeans were small farming villages. Then they ritually burned their cities every 60–80 years.

★ *A culture that voluntarily destroyed its own cities for reasons unknown.*

FACT #8

The Anasazi (Ancestral Puebloans) of the American Southwest abandoned the Chaco Canyon civilisation around 1300 AD, leaving cliff dwellings perfectly preserved. Recent climate research suggests prolonged drought drove them to migrate.

★ *Empty cliff dwellings, perfectly intact, abandoned 700 years ago.*

FACT #9

The Mycenaean civilisation of Greece — the world of Homer's Iliad — collapsed around 1200 BC. Its writing system (Linear B) was lost, then rediscovered and

decoded only in 1952 — proving Homer's "myths" had factual basis.

★ *Greece forgot how to write for 400 years and lost its own bronze age memory.*

FACT #10

The Easter Island (Rapa Nui) civilisation built nearly 1,000 moai stone statues, then collapsed around 1722 AD — possibly through environmental destruction, possibly through European disease and slavery raids. The truth is still debated.

★ *A civilisation that may have destroyed itself, or been destroyed — we cannot tell.*

ROUND 2**True or False (10 statements · 1 pt each)**

Based on the Fact Bombs above.

1. The Indus Valley script has been decoded.
TRUE / FALSE
2. Göbekli Tepe is older than Stonehenge.
TRUE / FALSE
3. The Sea Peoples have been definitively identified by historians.
TRUE / FALSE
4. Angkor was the largest pre-industrial city in the world.
TRUE / FALSE
5. The Olmec moved 40-tonne stone heads without wheels.
TRUE / FALSE
6. The Nabataean Kingdom's decline followed a 363 AD earthquake.
TRUE / FALSE
7. The Cucuteni-Trypillian culture built cities of up to 15,000 people.
TRUE / FALSE
8. The Anasazi were eradicated by a single catastrophic event.
TRUE / FALSE
9. Linear B was decoded in 1952.
TRUE / FALSE
10. The cause of Easter Island's collapse is universally agreed.
TRUE / FALSE

ROUND 3**Could You Have Guessed? (10 questions · 1 pt each)**

Four options — choose the correct one.

1. How old is Göbekli Tepe approximately?
 - A. 5,000 years
 - B. 7,000 years
 - C. 11,000–12,000 years
 - D. 20,000 years
2. How many years older is Göbekli Tepe than the Pyramids?

- A. 1,000
 - B. 3,000
 - C. 6,000
 - D. 10,000
- 3. What was Angkor's peak population?**
- A. 100,000
 - B. 350,000
 - C. 750,000
 - D. 2 million
- 4. How heavy were the largest Olmec stone heads?**
- A. 10 tonnes
 - B. 20 tonnes
 - C. 40 tonnes
 - D. 80 tonnes
- 5. How far did the Olmec transport their stone heads?**
- A. 10 km
 - B. 30 km
 - C. 80 km
 - D. 200 km
- 6. What event devastated the Nabataeans?**
- A. Roman conquest
 - B. 363 AD earthquake
 - C. Christian missionaries
 - D. A famine
- 7. How often did the Cucuteni-Trypillian culture burn their cities?**
- A. Every 20 years
 - B. Every 60-80 years
 - C. Every 100 years
 - D. Every 250 years
- 8. When was Linear B decoded?**
- A. 1923
 - B. 1952
 - C. 1977
 - D. 1991
- 9. How many moai statues did Easter Island build?**
- A. ~100
 - B. ~500

C. ~1,000

D. ~5,000

10. When did Easter Island civilisation collapse?

A. ~1500

B. ~1600

C. ~1722

D. ~1850

ROUND 4**Quick Fire (10 questions · 1 pt each)**

Short answers — no options. Write from memory.

- 1.** What is the famous Mayan calendar prediction date?

Answer:

- 2.** Where is Machu Picchu located?

Answer:

- 3.** Who discovered Machu Picchu?

Answer:

- 4.** What civilisation built Stonehenge?

Answer:

- 5.** Where was Carthage located?

Answer:

- 6.** What was the capital of the Aztec Empire?

Answer:

- 7.** In what year did Constantinople fall?

Answer:

- 8.** Who were the Phoenicians?

Answer:

- 9.** What is the world's oldest continuously inhabited city?

Answer:

- 10.** What is the Rosetta Stone?

Answer:

ROUND 5**Stump Your Friends! (15 harder questions · 1 pt each)**

The expert round. No mercy.

1. The Indus Valley Civilisation's major cities included:

- A. Babylon and Ur
- B. Mohenjo-Daro and Harappa
- C. Memphis and Thebes
- D. Knossos and Mycenae

2. The Etruscan civilisation flourished in modern:

- A. Northern Italy
- B. Central Italy (Tuscany)
- C. Southern Italy
- D. Sicily

3. The Hittite Empire was destroyed approximately when?

- A. 1500 BC
- B. 1200 BC
- C. 800 BC
- D. 500 BC

4. The Minoan civilisation was based on:

- A. Crete
- B. Cyprus
- C. Rhodes
- D. Malta

5. The Maya civilisation's "Classic Period" ended approximately when?

- A. 200 AD
- B. 500 AD
- C. 900 AD
- D. 1200 AD

6. The first European to circumnavigate the globe was:

- A. Magellan (he died on the journey)
- B. Vasco da Gama
- C. Sir Francis Drake
- D. Christopher Columbus

7. The Phoenicians invented the precursor to which writing system?

- A. Cuneiform
- B. The Greek alphabet
- C. Egyptian hieroglyphics
- D. Chinese characters

8. How tall are the largest Easter Island moai?

- A. 3 metres
- B. 6 metres
- C. 10 metres
- D. 22 metres

9. The Bronze Age Collapse occurred approximately when?

- A. 1500 BC
- B. 1200 BC
- C. 800 BC
- D. 500 BC

10. How long did the Roman Empire last?

- A. 100 years
- B. 300 years
- C. 500 years
- D. Over 1,000 years (counting Byzantine)

11. The Mughal Empire ended in:

- A. 1707
- B. 1757
- C. 1857
- D. 1947

12. The Mongol Empire at its peak covered approximately:

- A. 10% of Earth's land
- B. 15% of Earth's land
- C. 24% of Earth's land
- D. 40% of Earth's land

13. The Sumerian "Epic of Gilgamesh" was rediscovered in:

- A. Ancient Library of Alexandria
- B. 19th century at Nineveh
- C. Roman archaeological dig in Pompeii
- D. Egyptian tomb in 1922

14. Carthage was destroyed by Rome in:

- A. 202 BC
- B. 146 BC
- C. 73 BC
- D. 29 BC

15. The Minoan civilisation's sudden collapse may have been caused by:

- A. Volcanic eruption (Thera/Santorini)
- B. Mycenaean invasion
- C. Disease
- D. All of these may have contributed

MY SCORE: Q1...../10 Q2...../10 Q3...../10 Q4...../10 Q5...../10
TOTAL: ____/45

CHAPTER NOTE *Civilisations are not permanent. They rise, dominate, and disappear — sometimes leaving precise records, sometimes leaving nothing but ruins we cannot decipher. Every "lost" civilisation is a reminder that ours, too, is temporary.*

CHAPTER 7 — ANSWER KEY

Round 2 — True or False

1. The Indus Valley script has been decoded. → **FALSE**
2. Göbekli Tepe is older than Stonehenge. → **TRUE**
3. The Sea Peoples have been definitively identified by historians. → **FALSE**
4. Angkor was the largest pre-industrial city in the world. → **TRUE**
5. The Olmec moved 40-tonne stone heads without wheels. → **TRUE**
6. The Nabataean Kingdom's decline followed a 363 AD earthquake. → **TRUE**
7. The Cucuteni-Trypillian culture built cities of up to 15,000 people → **TRUE**
8. The Anasazi were eradicated by a single catastrophic event. → **FALSE**
9. Linear B was decoded in 1952. → **TRUE**
10. The cause of Easter Island's collapse is universally agreed. → **FALSE**

Round 3 — Multiple Choice

1. How old is Göbekli Tepe approximately? → **C. 11,000–12,000 years**
2. How many years older is Göbekli Tepe than the Pyramids? → **C. 6,000**
3. What was Angkor's peak population? → **C. 750,000**
4. How heavy were the largest Olmec stone heads? → **C. 40 tonnes**
5. How far did the Olmec transport their stone heads? → **C. 80 km**
6. What event devastated the Nabataeans? → **B. 363 AD earthquake**
7. How often did the Cucuteni-Trypillian culture burn their cities? → **B. Every 60-80 years**
8. When was Linear B decoded? → **B. 1952**
9. How many moai statues did Easter Island build? → **C. ~1,000**
10. When did Easter Island civilisation collapse? → **C. ~1722**

Round 4 — Quick Fire

1. What is the famous Mayan calendar prediction date? → **December 21, 2012 (end of Long Count cycle)**
2. Where is Machu Picchu located? → **Peru**
3. Who discovered Machu Picchu? → **Hiram Bingham (re-discovered, 1911)**
4. What civilisation built Stonehenge? → **Late Neolithic and early Bronze Age peoples of Britain**
5. Where was Carthage located? → **Modern Tunisia**
6. What was the capital of the Aztec Empire? → **Tenochtitlán**
7. In what year did Constantinople fall? → **1453**
8. Who were the Phoenicians? → **Mediterranean maritime traders from modern Lebanon**
9. What is the world's oldest continuously inhabited city? → **Damascus or Jericho (debated)**

10. What is the Rosetta Stone? → A bilingual stele that allowed the decoding of Egyptian hieroglyphics

Round 5 — Stump Your Friends!

- 1. The Indus Valley Civilisation's major cities included: → B. Mohenjo-Daro and Harappa**
- 2. The Etruscan civilisation flourished in modern: → B. Central Italy (Tuscany)**
- 3. The Hittite Empire was destroyed approximately when? → B. 1200 BC**
- 4. The Minoan civilisation was based on: → A. Crete**
- 5. The Maya civilisation's "Classic Period" ended approx → C. 900 AD**
- 6. The first European to circumnavigate the globe was: → A. Magellan (he died on the journey)**
- 7. The Phoenicians invented the precursor to which writing → B. The Greek alphabet**
- 8. How tall are the largest Easter Island moai? → C. 10 metres**
- 9. The Bronze Age Collapse occurred approximately when? → B. 1200 BC**
- 10. How long did the Roman Empire last? → D. Over 1,000 years (counting Byzantine)**
- 11. The Mughal Empire ended in: → C. 1857**
- 12. The Mongol Empire at its peak covered approximately: → C. 24% of Earth's land**
- 13. The Sumerian "Epic of Gilgamesh" was rediscovered in: → B. 19th century at Nineveh**
- 14. Carthage was destroyed by Rome in: → B. 146 BC**
- 15. The Minoan civilisation's sudden collapse may have been → D. All of these may have contributed**

Halfway Through — And You've Already Learned Things They Hid From You.

You've now completed seven chapters and encountered over 70 verified historical facts that most school curricula systematically avoid. If even one of them has changed how you see the past, that's exactly what this book was designed to do.

FEEDBACK & CONTACT *Enjoyed the challenge? Share your feedback at snappgrid.com/contact.*

The second half begins on the next page.

Lost Civilisations · Forbidden Science · Cults · Hidden Crimes · Secret Lives · Government Lies · Mystery Files · Forgotten Disasters

CHAPTER 08 • FORBIDDEN HISTORY

Forbidden Science & Suppressed Discoveries

Some scientific truths were so disturbing, so politically inconvenient, or so commercially threatening that powerful interests actively buried them. Many are now mainstream. Some are still suppressed.

ROUND 1 — FACT BOMBS

Read all 10 facts carefully. Your scored rounds follow.

FACT #1

Galileo Galilei was placed under house arrest by the Catholic Church in 1633 for proving heliocentrism. The Church only formally apologised in 1992 — 359 years later.

★ *It took the Catholic Church over three centuries to admit Earth orbits the Sun.*

FACT #2

The dangers of leaded gasoline were known to its inventors in the 1920s. The lead industry suppressed research for over 60 years. By the time leaded gasoline was banned, an estimated 100 million IQ points had been lost globally.

★ *A century of mass IQ reduction caused by a known industrial poison.*

FACT #3

Tobacco companies' internal documents (released in the 1990s "Master Settlement") showed they had known cigarettes caused cancer since at least the 1950s. They concealed the evidence and funded fake "research" denying the link for over 40 years.

★ *A 40-year conspiracy that killed millions, documented in the perpetrators' own records.*

FACT #4

In the 1960s, the sugar industry secretly paid Harvard scientists to publish research blaming fat — not sugar — for heart disease. This study influenced US dietary guidelines for 40 years and is now considered a textbook case of corporate science fraud.

★ *The American obesity epidemic was partly engineered by a paid academic deception.*

FACT #5

The Tuskegee Syphilis Study (1932–1972) involved the US Public Health Service deliberately denying treatment to 399 African American men with syphilis to study its progression. They were never told they had the disease. Many died.

★ *A US government medical experiment on its own citizens, run for 40 years.*

FACT #6

The Stanford Prison Experiment (1971), often cited as proof of how power corrupts, has been substantially debunked. Recordings show researchers actively coached "guards" to be cruel. The original results were not what was reported.

★ *A famous psychology experiment that was largely staged.*

FACT #7

Cigarette manufacturers added bronchodilators to cigarettes specifically to make smoking feel less harsh — facilitating addiction. They also adjusted nicotine levels chemically to ensure dependency.

★ *Cigarettes were chemically engineered to be more addictive.*

FACT #8

In the 1950s, the CIA's "Project MKUltra" administered LSD and other drugs to unwitting subjects — including American citizens — without consent, in attempts to develop mind control. Records were largely destroyed in 1973 to avoid prosecution.

★ *The CIA dosed Americans with LSD as part of a mind control programme.*

FACT #9

Fluoride was originally added to public water supplies starting in 1945 partly to dispose of industrial waste

from aluminium and fertiliser production. The decades-long debate about its safety continues.

★ *A "public health" measure that began as a waste disposal solution.*

FACT #10

The "Coral Castle" in Florida was built by a single 5'0", 100-pound man named Ed Leedskalnin between 1923 and 1951 — using stones weighing up to 30 tonnes. He claimed knowledge of "lost building secrets of the pyramids" and worked entirely alone.

★ *A single small man built a stone monument that modern engineers cannot fully explain.*

ROUND 2**True or False (10 statements · 1 pt each)**

Based on the Fact Bombs above.

1. The Catholic Church apologised to Galileo in 1992.
TRUE / FALSE
2. Lead's dangers were known to gasoline inventors in the 1920s.
TRUE / FALSE
3. Tobacco companies began acknowledging cancer links in the 1960s.
TRUE / FALSE
4. The sugar industry secretly paid Harvard researchers in the 1960s.
TRUE / FALSE
5. The Tuskegee Syphilis Study lasted 40 years.
TRUE / FALSE
6. The Stanford Prison Experiment was completely organic and unstaged.
TRUE / FALSE
7. Cigarette companies chemically engineered cigarettes for addiction.
TRUE / FALSE
8. MKUltra subjects always gave informed consent.
TRUE / FALSE
9. Water fluoridation began partly as industrial waste disposal.
TRUE / FALSE
10. Ed Leedskalnin built Coral Castle entirely alone.
TRUE / FALSE

ROUND 3**Could You Have Guessed? (10 questions · 1 pt each)**

Four options — choose the correct one.

1. How many years before the Catholic Church apologised to Galileo?
 - A. 100
 - B. 200
 - C. 300

- D. 359**
- 2. How many global IQ points were lost to lead gasoline?**
- A. 10 million
 - B. 50 million
 - C. 100 million
 - D. 500 million
- 3. How long did tobacco companies suppress cancer evidence?**
- A. 10 years
 - B. 25 years
 - C. 40+ years
 - D. 60 years
- 4. The Tuskegee Syphilis Study targeted approximately how many men?**
- A. 100
 - B. 400
 - C. 1,000
 - D. 5,000
- 5. When was MKUltra primarily active?**
- A. 1940s
 - B. 1950s-60s
 - C. 1970s
 - D. 1980s
- 6. How heavy were the largest stones at Coral Castle?**
- A. 5 tonnes
 - B. 15 tonnes
 - C. 30 tonnes
 - D. 60 tonnes
- 7. In what year did the US ban leaded gasoline (in regular use)?**
- A. 1986
 - B. 1996
 - C. 2003
 - D. It is still in some uses
- 8. How long did the Tuskegee study last?**
- A. 10 years
 - B. 20 years
 - C. 40 years

D. 60 years

9. The Stanford Prison Experiment was conducted in what year?

A. 1961

B. 1971

C. 1981

D. 1991

10. When did MKUltra records get largely destroyed?

A. 1953

B. 1963

C. 1973

D. 1983

ROUND 4**Quick Fire (10 questions · 1 pt each)**

Short answers — no options. Write from memory.

1. Who proposed the heliocentric theory before Galileo?

Answer:

2. What is the chemical symbol for lead?

Answer:

3. What does CIA stand for?

Answer:

4. Who developed the polio vaccine?

Answer:

5. In what year did smoking get linked to lung cancer scientifically?

Answer:

6. What is informed consent?

Answer:

7. What was Project Sunshine?

Answer:

8. Who was Henrietta Lacks?

Answer:

9. What are "ghostwritten" academic papers?

Answer:

10. What is the FDA?

Answer:

ROUND 5**Stump Your Friends! (15 harder questions · 1 pt each)**

The expert round. No mercy.

- 1. The "Helsinki Declaration" addresses:**
 - A. International law
 - B. Ethical principles for medical research on humans
 - C. Diplomatic protocols
 - D. Climate research
- 2. Which Nazi doctor escaped justice and worked in South America?**
 - A. Mengele
 - B. Heim
 - C. Eichmann
 - D. Both Mengele and Heim
- 3. The drug thalidomide caused birth defects in approximately how many babies?**
 - A. 1,000
 - B. 5,000
 - C. 10,000+
 - D. 100,000
- 4. In what year was the Nuremberg Code (medical ethics) established?**
 - A. 1947
 - B. 1957
 - C. 1967
 - D. 1977
- 5. How many people did Operation Paperclip recruit to the US?**
 - A. 100
 - B. 500
 - C. 1,500
 - D. 5,000
- 6. What was the Vietnam War-era "Agent Orange"?**
 - A. A defoliant containing dioxin causing cancer and birth defects
 - B. A nerve agent
 - C. A type of napalm
 - D. A radiation weapon
- 7. The "Rad Lab" at Berkeley conducted controversial:**
 - A. Atomic energy research
 - B. Plutonium injections in unwitting patients in the 1940s

- C. Cosmic ray research
 - D. Bomb testing
- 8. In what year did the FDA approve the first GMO food?**
- A. 1990
 - B. 1994 (Flavr Savr tomato)
 - C. 2000
 - D. 2010
- 9. The "Replication Crisis" in psychology emerged in:**
- A. 1980s
 - B. 1990s
 - C. 2010s
 - D. 2020s
- 10. How many "MKUltra" subprojects existed?**
- A. Around 30
 - B. Around 70
 - C. Around 149
 - D. Around 300
- 11. Which Nobel laureate later supported eugenics?**
- A. William Shockley (transistor)
 - B. Hermann Muller (mutation)
 - C. James Watson (DNA)
 - D. All of these
- 12. The "Saccharin Saga" involved a corporate cover-up by:**
- A. Coca-Cola
 - B. The sugar industry
 - C. GD Searle
 - D. Pfizer
- 13. In what year were US chemical weapon experiments on soldiers exposed?**
- A. 1955
 - B. 1975
 - C. 1995
 - D. 2015
- 14. The "Plutonium Files" by Eileen Welsome revealed:**
- A. Cold War nuclear secrets
 - B. Government experiments injecting plutonium into hospital patients

- C. Chernobyl truth
- D. Soviet biological weapons

15. How many MKUltra subjects were children?

- A. None known
- B. Approximately 50
- C. Approximately 200
- D. Numbers unknown

MY SCORE:

100% 100% 100% 100% 100% 100% 100% 100%

TOTAL: ____/45

CHAPTER NOTE *Science is supposed to be self-correcting — but it operates within institutions that can be captured by money, ideology, or political power. The historical record shows that "settled science" is sometimes settled because someone paid to settle it.*

CHAPTER 8 — ANSWER KEY

Round 2 — True or False

1. The Catholic Church apologised to Galileo in 1992. → **TRUE**
2. Lead's dangers were known to gasoline inventors in the 1920s. → **TRUE**
3. Tobacco companies began acknowledging cancer links in the 1960s. → **FALSE**
4. The sugar industry secretly paid Harvard researchers in the 1960s → **TRUE**
5. The Tuskegee Syphilis Study lasted 40 years. → **TRUE**
6. The Stanford Prison Experiment was completely organic and unstaged → **FALSE**
7. Cigarette companies chemically engineered cigarettes for addiction → **TRUE**
8. MKUltra subjects always gave informed consent. → **FALSE**
9. Water fluoridation began partly as industrial waste disposal. → **TRUE**
10. Ed Leedskalnin built Coral Castle entirely alone. → **TRUE**

Round 3 — Multiple Choice

1. How many years before the Catholic Church apologised to → **D. 359**
2. How many global IQ points were lost to lead gasoline? → **C. 100 million**
3. How long did tobacco companies suppress cancer evidence → **C. 40+ years**
4. The Tuskegee Syphilis Study targeted approximately how → **B. 400**
5. When was MKUltra primarily active? → **B. 1950s-60s**
6. How heavy were the largest stones at Coral Castle? → **C. 30 tonnes**
7. In what year did the US ban leaded gasoline (in regular → **B. 1996**
8. How long did the Tuskegee study last? → **C. 40 years**
9. The Stanford Prison Experiment was conducted in what year → **B. 1971**
10. When did MKUltra records get largely destroyed? → **C. 1973**

Round 4 — Quick Fire

1. Who proposed the heliocentric theory before Galileo? → **Copernicus**
2. What is the chemical symbol for lead? → **Pb**
3. What does CIA stand for? → **Central Intelligence Agency**
4. Who developed the polio vaccine? → **Jonas Salk**
5. In what year did smoking get linked to lung cancer scientifically? → **1950 (Doll and Hill study)**
6. What is informed consent? → **Voluntary agreement to a procedure with full understanding of risks**
7. What was Project Sunshine? → **A 1950s US program studying radiation in human bones (some collected without consent)**
8. Who was Henrietta Lacks? → **African-American woman whose cells (HeLa) became the first immortal human cell line, used without her consent**

9. What are "ghostwritten" academic papers? → **Papers actually written by industry but published under academic names**
10. What is the FDA? → **Food and Drug Administration (US)**

Round 5 — Stump Your Friends!

1. The "Helsinki Declaration" addresses: → **B. Ethical principles for medical research on humans**
2. Which Nazi doctor escaped justice and worked in South A → **D. Both Mengele and Heim**
3. The drug thalidomide caused birth defects in approximat → **C. 10,000+**
4. In what year was the Nuremberg Code (medical ethics) es → **A. 1947**
5. How many people did Operation Paperclip recruit to the → **C. 1,500**
6. What was the Vietnam War-era "Agent Orange"? → **A. A defoliant containing dioxin causing cancer and birth defects**
7. The "Rad Lab" at Berkeley conducted controversial: → **B. Plutonium injections in unwitting patients in the 1940s**
8. In what year did the FDA approve the first GMO food? → **B. 1994 (Flavr Savr tomato)**
9. The "Replication Crisis" in psychology emerged in: → **C. 2010s**
10. How many "MKUltra" subprojects existed? → **C. Around 149**
11. Which Nobel laureate later supported eugenics? → **D. All of these**
12. The "Saccharin Saga" involved a corporate cover-up by: → **B. The sugar industry**
13. In what year were US chemical weapon experiments on sol → **B. 1975**
14. The "Plutonium Files" by Eileen Welsome revealed: → **B. Government experiments injecting plutonium into hospital patients**
15. How many MKUltra subjects were children? → **D. Numbers unknown**

CHAPTER 09 • FORBIDDEN HISTORY

Cults, Conspiracies & Hidden Religious Truths

For every official religion, there are a hundred forgotten ones. For every documented cult, ten more remain unknown. Some are charming. Most ended very badly.

ROUND 1 — FACT BOMBS

Read all 10 facts carefully. Your scored rounds follow.

FACT #1

On 18 November 1978, Jim Jones led 909 members of the People's Temple in mass suicide-murder by cyanide-laced Flavor Aid in Jonestown, Guyana — including 304 children. The phrase "drinking the Kool-Aid" comes from this event.

★ *A modern English idiom is named after the death of 304 children.*

FACT #2

The Heaven's Gate cult conducted a mass suicide in 1997, with 39 members dying together believing they would board a UFO trailing the Hale-Bopp comet. They were dressed in matching tracksuits and Nikes, with \$5.75 in their pockets.

★ *A mass suicide with a wardrobe and footwear theme.*

FACT #3

The Branch Davidian compound in Waco, Texas was raided by the FBI in 1993. Following a 51-day siege, the compound burned, killing 76 people including 25 children. The cause of the fire is still officially disputed.

★ *A 51-day government siege ending in a fire that killed 25 children.*

FACT #4

The Jonestown massacre was investigated by US Congressman Leo Ryan, who was murdered there along with several others before the mass deaths. His congressional ID badge was found among the dead.

★ *A US congressman was assassinated investigating a cult.*

FACT #5

The "Manson Family" murders of 1969 — including the killing of pregnant actress Sharon Tate — were partially motivated by Charles Manson's belief that the Beatles' "White Album" contained coded messages predicting an apocalyptic race war he called "Helter Skelter."

★ *A serial killer's philosophy was based on misreading a pop album.*

FACT #6

The Aum Shinrikyo cult released sarin gas on the Tokyo subway in 1995, killing 13 and injuring over 6,000. The cult had attempted to develop biological weapons including anthrax, ebola, and botulinum.

★ *A doomsday cult that successfully developed weapons of mass destruction.*

FACT #7

The Order of the Solar Temple conducted three mass suicides between 1994 and 1997, killing 74 members across Switzerland, France, and Canada. They believed leaders would be transported to a planet near Sirius.

★ *A multi-country mass suicide cult tied to a star 8.6 light-years away.*

FACT #8

The Children of God cult (now "The Family International") encouraged child sexual abuse as a recruitment tactic in the 1970s and 80s, calling it "Flirty Fishing." Many former child members became victims, including actor Joaquin Phoenix's family.

★ *A cult that recruited through systematic child abuse.*

FACT #9

The Movement for the Restoration of the Ten Commandments of God in Uganda (2000) killed approximately 778 members, including children, by

burning them alive in a church. It was one of the largest cult mass killings in history.

★ *A cult that locked its members in a church and set it on fire.*

FACT #10

NXIVM (pronounced "Nexium") was a secretive personal development organisation that operated as a sex-trafficking cult under leader Keith Raniere. Members were branded with his initials. He was sentenced to 120 years in prison in 2020.

★ *A "self-improvement" group that branded members with the founder's initials.*

ROUND 2**True or False (10 statements · 1 pt each)**

Based on the Fact Bombs above.

1. Jim Jones led the Jonestown mass suicide in 1978.
TRUE / FALSE
2. Heaven's Gate suicides involved 39 members in matching tracksuits.
TRUE / FALSE
3. The Waco siege resulted in 76 deaths.
TRUE / FALSE
4. Congressman Leo Ryan was killed at Jonestown.
TRUE / FALSE
5. Charles Manson's "Helter Skelter" was inspired by an Elvis song.
TRUE / FALSE
6. Aum Shinrikyo released sarin gas on the Tokyo subway.
TRUE / FALSE
7. The Order of the Solar Temple believed in transportation to a planet near Sirius.
TRUE / FALSE
8. The Children of God cult openly encouraged child welfare.
TRUE / FALSE
9. The Ugandan Movement for the Restoration of the Ten Commandments killed approximately 778 members.
TRUE / FALSE
10. NXIVM members were branded with the founder's initials.
TRUE / FALSE

ROUND 3**Could You Have Guessed? (10 questions · 1 pt each)**

Four options — choose the correct one.

1. How many died at Jonestown?
 - A. 309
 - B. 609
 - C. 909
 - D. 1,909

- 2. How many children died at Jonestown?**
 - A. 100
 - B. 200
 - C. 304
 - D. 500
- 3. How many people died at Heaven's Gate?**
 - A. 19
 - B. 39
 - C. 79
 - D. 139
- 4. How long was the Waco siege?**
 - A. 11 days
 - B. 21 days
 - C. 51 days
 - D. 81 days
- 5. How many died in the Aum Shinrikyo subway attack?**
 - A. 3
 - B. 13
 - C. 30
 - D. 130
- 6. How many were injured in the Tokyo subway sarin attack?**
 - A. 600
 - B. 1,600
 - C. 6,000+
 - D. 60,000
- 7. How many died in the Solar Temple mass suicides?**
 - A. 24
 - B. 74
 - C. 174
 - D. 274
- 8. How many died in the 2000 Ugandan cult tragedy?**
 - A. 278
 - B. 578
 - C. 778
 - D. 1,278
- 9. NXIVM's leader Keith Raniere received a sentence of:**
 - A. 20 years

- B. 60 years
- C. 120 years
- D. Life

10. Manson's "Helter Skelter" came from which Beatles album?

- A. Sgt. Pepper
- B. The White Album
- C. Abbey Road
- D. Let It Be

ROUND 4**Quick Fire (10 questions · 1 pt each)**

Short answers — no options. Write from memory.

1. In what year was Jonestown?

Answer:

2. Where did the Jonestown massacre occur?

Answer:

3. Who founded Scientology?

Answer:

4. In what year was the Waco siege?

Answer:

5. Who founded the Mormon Church?

Answer:

6. What was the FLDS Church?

Answer:

7. In what year was the Heaven's Gate suicide?

Answer:

8. What is "Operation Snow White"?

Answer:

9. What was Charles Manson's "family"?

Answer:

10. In what year did the Aum Shinrikyo subway attack occur?

Answer:

ROUND 5**Stump Your Friends! (15 harder questions · 1 pt each)**

The expert round. No mercy.

- 1. Jim Jones moved his church from where to Jonestown?**
 - A. New York
 - B. Los Angeles
 - C. San Francisco
 - D. Atlanta
- 2. The Branch Davidians believed their leader was:**
 - A. God
 - B. A reincarnation of Christ
 - C. The Final Prophet
 - D. David Koresh — a messianic figure
- 3. How long did the Waco siege last specifically?**
 - A. 51 days
 - B. 61 days
 - C. 71 days
 - D. 91 days
- 4. Aum Shinrikyo was founded by:**
 - A. Shoko Asahara
 - B. Hiroshi Yamashita
 - C. Yasuo Hayashi
 - D. Toshihiro Saito
- 5. In what year was Charles Manson convicted?**
 - A. 1969
 - B. 1971
 - C. 1973
 - D. 1975
- 6. The Solar Temple mass suicides occurred in which countries?**
 - A. Switzerland and France
 - B. Switzerland, France, and Canada
 - C. Switzerland and Italy
 - D. France and Belgium
- 7. How many wives did David Koresh have at Waco?**
 - A. Officially one
 - B. Estimates of multiple "spiritual" wives, some underage
 - C. Three
 - D. Twelve

8. Aum Shinrikyo executive Shoko Asahara was executed in:

- A. 2006
- B. 2014
- C. 2018
- D. 2022

9. How many were initially involved in the Waco compound?

- A. ~30
- B. ~80
- C. ~120
- D. ~200

10. NXIVM was based in:

- A. New York
- B. Vancouver
- C. Albany
- D. Los Angeles

11. How many followers did Charles Manson have at peak?

- A. 10
- B. 25-30
- C. 100
- D. 200

12. What was the True Knot in cult studies?

- A. A White Supremacist group
- B. A polygamy-practising LDS offshoot
- C. A Stephen King fictional cult
- D. A 1970s commune

13. The Peoples Temple had how many members at peak?

- A. 1,000
- B. 3,000
- C. 5,000
- D. 15,000

14. What was Keith Raniere's NXIVM rank pyramid called?

- A. DOS — "Dominus Obsequious Sororium"
- B. The Vow

- C. The Master Class
- D. The Seven Levels

15. How many people did the Order of the Solar Temple kill across all its mass suicides?

- A. 74
- B. 94
- C. 174
- D. 274

MY SCORE:

100% 100% 100% 100% 100% 100% 100% 100%

TOTAL: ____/45

CHAPTER NOTE *Cults are not bizarre exceptions — they are extreme expressions of patterns present in many institutions: charismatic leadership, isolation from outside reality, escalating commitment, and gradual moral surrender. Studying them tells you something about how people work.*

CHAPTER 9 — ANSWER KEY

Round 2 — True or False

1. Jim Jones led the Jonestown mass suicide in 1978. → **TRUE**
2. Heaven's Gate suicides involved 39 members in matching tracksuits → **TRUE**
3. The Waco siege resulted in 76 deaths. → **TRUE**
4. Congressman Leo Ryan was killed at Jonestown. → **TRUE**
5. Charles Manson's "Helter Skelter" was inspired by an Elvis song. → **FALSE**
6. Aum Shinrikyo released sarin gas on the Tokyo subway. → **TRUE**
7. The Order of the Solar Temple believed in transportation to a pla → **TRUE**
8. The Children of God cult openly encouraged child welfare. → **FALSE**
9. The Ugandan Movement for the Restoration of the Ten Commandments → **TRUE**
10. NXIVM members were branded with the founder's initials. → **TRUE**

Round 3 — Multiple Choice

1. How many died at Jonestown? → **C. 909**
2. How many children died at Jonestown? → **C. 304**
3. How many people died at Heaven's Gate? → **B. 39**
4. How long was the Waco siege? → **C. 51 days**
5. How many died in the Aum Shinrikyo subway attack? → **B. 13**
6. How many were injured in the Tokyo subway sarin attack? → **C. 6,000+**
7. How many died in the Solar Temple mass suicides? → **B. 74**
8. How many died in the 2000 Ugandan cult tragedy? → **C. 778**
9. NXIVM's leader Keith Raniere received a sentence of: → **C. 120 years**
10. Manson's "Helter Skelter" came from which Beatles album → **B. The White Album**

Round 4 — Quick Fire

1. In what year was Jonestown? → **1978**
2. Where did the Jonestown massacre occur? → **Guyana**
3. Who founded Scientology? → **L. Ron Hubbard**
4. In what year was the Waco siege? → **1993**
5. Who founded the Mormon Church? → **Joseph Smith**
6. What was the FLDS Church? → **Fundamentalist Latter-day Saints — practising polygamy**
7. In what year was the Heaven's Gate suicide? → **1997**
8. What is "Operation Snow White"? → **Scientology's 1970s infiltration of US government agencies**
9. What was Charles Manson's "family"? → **A commune cult he led, responsible for the Tate-LaBianca murders**
10. In what year did the Aum Shinrikyo subway attack occur? → **1995**

Round 5 — Stump Your Friends!

1. Jim Jones moved his church from where to Jonestown? → **C. San Francisco**
2. The Branch Davidians believed their leader was: → **D. David Koresh — a messianic figure**
3. How long did the Waco siege last specifically? → **A. 51 days**
4. Aum Shinrikyo was founded by: → **A. Shoko Asahara**
5. In what year was Charles Manson convicted? → **B. 1971**
6. The Solar Temple mass suicides occurred in which countr → **B. Switzerland, France, and Canada**
7. How many wives did David Koresh have at Waco? → **B. Estimates of multiple "spiritual" wives, some underage**
8. Aum Shinrikyo executive Shoko Asahara was executed in: → **C. 2018**
9. How many were initially involved in the Waco compound? → **B. ~80**
10. NXIVM was based in: → **C. Albany**
11. How many followers did Charles Manson have at peak? → **B. 25-30**
12. What was the True Knot in cult studies? → **C. A Stephen King fictional cult**
13. The Peoples Temple had how many members at peak? → **B. 3,000**
14. What was Keith Raniere's NXIVM rank pyramid called? → **A. DOS — "Dominus Obsequious Sororium"**
15. How many people did the Order of the Solar Temple kill → **A. 74**

CHAPTER 10 • FORBIDDEN HISTORY

Real Crimes They Quietly Forgot

Some crimes were too vast, too embarrassing, or too politically inconvenient to teach. They are documented, verified, and almost completely missing from public memory.

ROUND 1 — FACT BOMBS

Read all 10 facts carefully. Your scored rounds follow.

FACT #1

Belgium's King Leopold II personally owned the Congo Free State (1885–1908) as private property. His agents killed an estimated 8–15 million Congolese in pursuit of rubber profits — through forced labour, mutilation, starvation, and execution.

★ *A European king personally killed millions for rubber.*

FACT #2

The 1937 Nanjing Massacre saw Imperial Japanese forces kill an estimated 200,000–300,000 Chinese civilians in approximately six weeks. Japan's government continues to officially dispute the scale of the atrocity.

★ *A massacre that an entire nation's government still officially denies.*

FACT #3

During the Stalin-era Holodomor famine of 1932–33, Soviet authorities deliberately confiscated food from Ukraine to crush resistance. An estimated 3.5–7 million Ukrainians died of starvation. The Soviet Union officially denied it occurred for 50 years.

★ *A famine the Soviet Union pretended never happened, for half a century.*

FACT #4

The "Bracero Program" (1942–1964) brought millions of Mexican workers to the US under contracts that systematically stole their wages. The mandatory 10% withheld for "savings" — approximately \$32 million — was simply never returned to most workers.

★ *The US government legally withheld and pocketed millions in workers' wages.*

FACT #5

Australia's "Stolen Generations" (1910–1970) involved government policies that forcibly removed an estimated 100,000 Aboriginal children from their families to be raised in white Christian institutions or families. Many were abused.

★ *A 60-year government program of mass child abduction.*

FACT #6

Canada's residential school system (1880s–1996) forcibly separated approximately 150,000 Indigenous children from their families. An estimated 6,000+ died at the schools, often from disease, abuse, and neglect. Many graves remain unidentified.

★ *A school system that produced thousands of unmarked graves.*

FACT #7

The British Empire's 1943 Bengal Famine killed an estimated 3 million people. Winston Churchill's war cabinet diverted Indian food supplies to Allied stockpiles, knowing the consequences. Churchill reportedly said the famine was the Indians' fault for "breeding like rabbits."

★ *A genocide-by-policy that British history rarely acknowledges.*

FACT #8

The German South West Africa genocide (1904–1908) of the Herero and Nama peoples killed an estimated 65–80% of the Herero population. Captives were placed in concentration camps — a model later used in Nazi Germany.

★ *The original blueprint for the Holocaust was tested on Africans in 1904.*

FACT #9

The Armenian Genocide (1915–1923) saw Ottoman Turkey systematically murder an estimated 1–1.5

million Armenian Christians. Turkey continues to officially deny it was genocide despite international consensus.

★ *A genocide whose existence its perpetrator nation still legally denies.*

FACT #10

In 1932–1972, the US government conducted the "Tuskegee Syphilis Study" on 399 African American men, deliberately denying treatment to study the disease's progression. The men were never told they had syphilis.

★ *A 40-year US government experiment on its own citizens that violated every medical ethic.*

ROUND 2**True or False (10 statements · 1 pt each)**

Based on the Fact Bombs above.

- 1.** King Leopold II personally owned the Congo as private property.

TRUE / FALSE

- 2.** The Nanjing Massacre is officially acknowledged by Japan today.

TRUE / FALSE

- 3.** The Holodomor was officially denied by the Soviet Union for 50 years.

TRUE / FALSE

- 4.** The Bracero Program returned all withheld wages to workers.

TRUE / FALSE

- 5.** Australia's Stolen Generations program ran for approximately 60 years.

TRUE / FALSE

- 6.** Canada's residential schools produced thousands of unmarked graves.

TRUE / FALSE

- 7.** Churchill's policies were unrelated to the 1943 Bengal Famine.

TRUE / FALSE

- 8.** The German genocide in South West Africa preceded the Holocaust.

TRUE / FALSE

- 9.** Turkey officially recognises the Armenian Genocide.

TRUE / FALSE

- 10.** The Tuskegee Study told participants they had syphilis.

TRUE / FALSE

ROUND 3**Could You Have Guessed? (10 questions · 1 pt each)**

Four options — choose the correct one.

- 1. How many Congolese died under Leopold II?**

- A. 1-2 million
- B. 5-7 million

- C. 8-15 million
 - D. 20-30 million
- 2. How many died in the Nanjing Massacre?**
- A. 10,000-30,000
 - B. 50,000-100,000
 - C. 200,000-300,000
 - D. 500,000-1 million
- 3. How many Ukrainians died in the Holodomor?**
- A. 100,000-500,000
 - B. 1-2 million
 - C. 3.5-7 million
 - D. 10-15 million
- 4. How many Aboriginal children were taken in Australia's Stolen Generations?**
- A. 10,000
 - B. 50,000
 - C. 100,000
 - D. 500,000
- 5. How many died in Canada's residential schools?**
- A. Hundreds
 - B. 6,000+
 - C. 100,000
 - D. Numbers unknown
- 6. How many died in the 1943 Bengal Famine?**
- A. 500,000
 - B. 1 million
 - C. 3 million
 - D. 10 million
- 7. What percentage of the Herero population died in the German South West Africa genocide?**
- A. 10-30%
 - B. 40-50%
 - C. 65-80%
 - D. Over 90%
- 8. How many Armenians died in the Armenian Genocide?**
- A. 100,000-500,000
 - B. 1-1.5 million

C. 3-5 million

D. 10 million

9. How long did the Tuskegee Syphilis Study last?

A. 10 years

B. 20 years

C. 40 years

D. 60 years

10. When did Australia formally apologise for the Stolen Generations?

A. 1990

B. 2000

C. 2008

D. 2015

ROUND 4**Quick Fire (10 questions • 1 pt each)**

Short answers — no options. Write from memory.

1. In what year did Belgium take ownership of the Congo from Leopold II?

Answer:

2. Who was Britain's PM during the 1943 Bengal Famine?

Answer:

3. What does "Holodomor" mean in Ukrainian?

Answer:

4. In what year did Canada formally apologise for residential schools?

Answer:

5. Who is recognised as the architect of the Armenian Genocide?

Answer:

6. What was Operation Condor?

Answer:

7. Who was Heinrich Goering (related to Hermann)?

Answer:

8. In what year did Stalin die?

Answer:

9. Who created the Apartheid system in South Africa?

Answer:

10. What was the "Trail of Tears"?

Answer:

ROUND 5

Stump Your Friends! (15 harder questions · 1 pt each)*The expert round. No mercy.*

- 1. King Leopold II's Congo regime was specifically based around:**
 - A. Diamonds
 - B. Rubber
 - C. Ivory
 - D. Copper
- 2. How long did the Nanjing Massacre last specifically?**
 - A. One week
 - B. Six weeks
 - C. Six months
 - D. One year
- 3. The Holodomor occurred during which Soviet leader's rule?**
 - A. Lenin
 - B. Stalin
 - C. Khrushchev
 - D. Brezhnev
- 4. How many died in the Cambodian Genocide?**
 - A. 500,000
 - B. 1 million
 - C. 1.5-2 million
 - D. 5 million
- 5. Pol Pot's regime was called:**
 - A. The Red Brigade
 - B. The Khmer Rouge
 - C. The Liberation Front
 - D. The People's Army
- 6. Idi Amin's regime in Uganda killed approximately:**
 - A. 50,000
 - B. 100,000
 - C. 300,000-500,000
 - D. 1 million
- 7. How long did Apartheid officially last in South Africa?**
 - A. 1948-1990 (~42 years)
 - B. 1960-1994 (~34 years)
 - C. 1948-1994 (~46 years)

D. 1937-1992 (~55 years)

8. How many died in the 1971 Bangladesh Liberation War?

- A. 100,000**
- B. 500,000**
- C. Up to 3 million**
- D. 5 million**

9. The "Operation Searchlight" massacre in Bangladesh occurred in:

- A. 1969**
- B. 1971**
- C. 1973**
- D. 1975**

10. How many Kulaks were killed under Stalin's collectivisation?

- A. 100,000**
- B. 500,000**
- C. 1.5 million**
- D. 5+ million**

11. How many Tibetans died from 1950-1970 under Chinese rule?

- A. 100,000**
- B. 500,000**
- C. 1 million**
- D. Numbers disputed (estimates 200k-1.2m)**

12. The Indonesian killings of 1965-66 killed approximately:

- A. 100,000**
- B. 500,000-1 million**
- C. 1.5-2 million**
- D. 3 million**

13. How many Vietnamese civilians died in the Vietnam War?

- A. 500,000**
- B. 1 million**
- C. 2-3 million**
- D. 5 million**

14. How many Native Americans were killed during the conquest of the Americas?

- A. 1-2 million
- B. 5-10 million
- C. 25-50 million
- D. Numbers disputed but immense

15. How many died in the East Pakistan / Bangladesh genocide of 1971?

- A. ~100,000
- B. ~500,000
- C. Estimates 300,000-3 million
- D. 5+ million

MY SCORE:

Q1..... Q2..... Q3..... Q4..... Q5..... Q6..... Q7..... Q8..... Q9..... Q10..... Q11..... Q12..... Q13..... Q14..... Q15.....

TOTAL: ____/45

CHAPTER NOTE *Crimes against humanity are usually committed by those who believe their cause justifies any cost. They are usually defended by those who benefit from forgetting them. The remembering itself is an act of resistance.*

CHAPTER 10 — ANSWER KEY

Round 2 — True or False

1. King Leopold II personally owned the Congo as private property. → **TRUE**
2. The Nanjing Massacre is officially acknowledged by Japan today. → **FALSE**
3. The Holodomor was officially denied by the Soviet Union for 50 ye → **TRUE**
4. The Bracero Program returned all withheld wages to workers. → **FALSE**
5. Australia's Stolen Generations program ran for approximately 60 y → **TRUE**
6. Canada's residential schools produced thousands of unmarked grave → **TRUE**
7. Churchill's policies were unrelated to the 1943 Bengal Famine. → **FALSE**
8. The German genocide in South West Africa preceded the Holocaust. → **TRUE**
9. Turkey officially recognises the Armenian Genocide. → **FALSE**
10. The Tuskegee Study told participants they had syphilis. → **FALSE**

Round 3 — Multiple Choice

1. How many Congolese died under Leopold II? → **C. 8-15 million**
2. How many died in the Nanjing Massacre? → **C. 200,000-300,000**
3. How many Ukrainians died in the Holodomor? → **C. 3.5-7 million**
4. How many Aboriginal children were taken in Australia's → **C. 100,000**
5. How many died in Canada's residential schools? → **B. 6,000+**
6. How many died in the 1943 Bengal Famine? → **C. 3 million**
7. What percentage of the Herero population died in the Ge → **C. 65-80%**
8. How many Armenians died in the Armenian Genocide? → **B. 1-1.5 million**
9. How long did the Tuskegee Syphilis Study last? → **C. 40 years**
10. When did Australia formally apologise for the Stolen Ge → **C. 2008**

Round 4 — Quick Fire

1. In what year did Belgium take ownership of the Congo from Leopold II? → **1908**
2. Who was Britain's PM during the 1943 Bengal Famine? → **Winston Churchill**
3. What does "Holodomor" mean in Ukrainian? → **Death by starvation / extermination by hunger**
4. In what year did Canada formally apologise for residential schools? → **2008**
5. Who is recognised as the architect of the Armenian Genocide? → **Talaat Pasha and the Three Pashas (Ottoman government)**
6. What was Operation Condor? → **A 1970s US-backed programme of state terror in South America**
7. Who was Heinrich Goering (related to Hermann)? → **Hermann Goering's father — the German governor of South West Africa**
8. In what year did Stalin die? → **1953**

9. Who created the Apartheid system in South Africa? → **The National Party (1948)**
10. What was the "Trail of Tears"? → **The forced relocation of Native Americans (especially Cherokee) in 1830s**

Round 5 — Stump Your Friends!

1. King Leopold II's Congo regime was specifically based a → **B. Rubber**
2. How long did the Nanjing Massacre last specifically? → **B. Six weeks**
3. The Holodomor occurred during which Soviet leader's rul → **B. Stalin**
4. How many died in the Cambodian Genocide? → **C. 1.5-2 million**
5. Pol Pot's regime was called: → **B. The Khmer Rouge**
6. Idi Amin's regime in Uganda killed approximately: → **C. 300,000-500,000**
7. How long did Apartheid officially last in South Africa? → **C. 1948-1994 (~46 years)**
8. How many died in the 1971 Bangladesh Liberation War? → **C. Up to 3 million**
9. The "Operation Searchlight" massacre in Bangladesh occu → **B. 1971**
10. How many Kulaks were killed under Stalin's collectivisa → **D. 5+ million**
11. How many Tibetans died from 1950-1970 under Chinese rul → **D. Numbers disputed (estimates 200k-1.2m)**
12. The Indonesian killings of 1965-66 killed approximately → **B. 500,000-1 million**
13. How many Vietnamese civilians died in the Vietnam War? → **C. 2-3 million**
14. How many Native Americans were killed during the conque → **D. Numbers disputed but immense**
15. How many died in the East Pakistan / Bangladesh genocid → **C. Estimates 300,000-3 million**

CHAPTER 11 • FORBIDDEN HISTORY

Hidden Histories of Famous People

The official biographies sanitise. The real lives — drug addiction, secret identities, criminal records, hypocrisies — are far more interesting and more honest about the human condition.

ROUND 1 — FACT BOMBS

Read all 10 facts carefully. Your scored rounds follow.

FACT #1

Sigmund Freud — the founder of psychoanalysis — was personally addicted to cocaine for over a decade and prescribed it heavily to his patients, including children. He claimed it cured depression, fatigue, and indigestion.

★ *The man who studied the unconscious was on cocaine for ten years.*

FACT #2

Mahatma Gandhi, despite his image as a saint, slept naked next to teenage girls — including his own great-niece — as a "test of celibacy" in his later years. He also wrote racist letters about Black South Africans during his time in Africa.

★ *A moral icon whose private practices included things that would now be criminal.*

FACT #3

Albert Einstein had a secret child with his first wife Mileva Marić — a daughter named Lieserl who was either given up for adoption or died of scarlet fever. She was kept secret from his second wife and most biographers for decades.

★ *The world's most famous physicist had a hidden daughter for nearly a century.*

FACT #4

Walt Disney secretly worked as an FBI informant for decades, naming colleagues he believed were Communist sympathisers. He was inducted into the FBI as "Special Agent in Charge" by J. Edgar Hoover.

★ *The creator of Mickey Mouse was an FBI snitch.*

FACT #5

Helen Keller — the deafblind activist remembered as an inspirational figure — was a committed socialist, suffragette, and supporter of birth control who criticised capitalism throughout her life. Her radicalism was systematically erased after her death.

★ *A famous activist whose actual political views were censored from her legacy.*

FACT #6

Charles Lindbergh — celebrated American hero for crossing the Atlantic in 1927 — was an avowed antisemite who supported Nazi Germany before WWII. He received a medal from Hermann Göring in 1938 and pushed for an isolationist policy.

★ *America's most famous pilot was a Nazi sympathiser.*

FACT #7

Mother Teresa — canonised by the Catholic Church as a saint — ran missions widely criticised for poor medical care, refusing pain relief to the dying as a "gift from God," and accepting donations from criminals like Charles Keating.

★ *A Catholic saint whose theology of suffering inflicted preventable pain on the dying.*

FACT #8

Thomas Jefferson — author of "all men are created equal" — owned over 600 enslaved people during his lifetime and fathered at least six children with his enslaved partner Sally Hemings, who was likely his late wife's half-sister.

★ *The man who wrote about equality kept his own family in chains.*

FACT #9

Nikola Tesla developed an obsession with pigeons in his later years, claiming to be deeply in love with one

specific white pigeon. He died alone in a New York hotel in 1943, surrounded by his birds.

★ *A genius who declared romantic love for a pigeon.*

FACT #10

John F. Kennedy was treated for severe Addison's disease, chronic back pain, and likely syphilis throughout his presidency. He was on a regimen of approximately 12 daily medications including stimulants, painkillers, and steroids.

★ *The president behind the Cuban Missile Crisis was on heavy daily drug cocktails.*

ROUND 2**True or False (10 statements · 1 pt each)**

Based on the Fact Bombs above.

1. Freud was personally addicted to cocaine for over a decade.
TRUE / FALSE
2. Gandhi engaged in practices in his later life that would now be criminal.
TRUE / FALSE
3. Einstein had a secret daughter named Lieserl.
TRUE / FALSE
4. Walt Disney was an FBI informant.
TRUE / FALSE
5. Helen Keller's radical political views were widely celebrated after her death.
TRUE / FALSE
6. Charles Lindbergh received a medal from Hermann Göring in 1938.
TRUE / FALSE
7. Mother Teresa accepted donations from convicted criminals.
TRUE / FALSE
8. Thomas Jefferson owned no enslaved people.
TRUE / FALSE
9. Tesla died alone in a hotel surrounded by pigeons.
TRUE / FALSE
10. JFK was on approximately 12 daily medications during his presidency.
TRUE / FALSE

ROUND 3**Could You Have Guessed? (10 questions · 1 pt each)**

Four options — choose the correct one.

1. Freud prescribed cocaine to which patient demographic?
 - A. Adults only
 - B. Including children
 - C. Only the wealthy

- D.** Only those with depression
- 2. How many enslaved people did Jefferson own during his life?**
- A.** ~50
 - B.** ~150
 - C.** ~600
 - D.** ~1,500
- 3. How many children did Jefferson father with Sally Hemings?**
- A.** Two
 - B.** Four
 - C.** At least six
 - D.** Twelve
- 4. In what year did Lindbergh receive his Nazi medal?**
- A.** 1932
 - B.** 1938
 - C.** 1941
 - D.** 1944
- 5. Who awarded Lindbergh the medal?**
- A.** Hitler
 - B.** Goebbels
 - C.** Göring
 - D.** Himmler
- 6. How many daily medications did JFK take?**
- A.** 3
 - B.** 7
 - C.** 12
 - D.** 20
- 7. In what year did Tesla die?**
- A.** 1933
 - B.** 1943
 - C.** 1953
 - D.** 1963
- 8. What was the name of Einstein's secret daughter?**
- A.** Margot
 - B.** Lieserl
 - C.** Helena
 - D.** Edith

9. Walt Disney's FBI title was:

- A. Informant
- B. Special Agent in Charge
- C. Confidential Source
- D. Asset

10. Mother Teresa was criticised for accepting donations from:

- A. Charles Keating only
- B. Multiple criminals including Charles Keating
- C. The Vatican
- D. Hollywood celebrities

ROUND 4**Quick Fire (10 questions · 1 pt each)**

Short answers — no options. Write from memory.

1. Who was Sigmund Freud's most famous student?

Answer:

2. In what year was Gandhi assassinated?

Answer:

3. What is Einstein's most famous equation?

Answer:

4. What was Walt Disney's first major animated film?

Answer:

5. Who wrote the Declaration of Independence?

Answer:

6. In what year did JFK become President?

Answer:

7. Who was Helen Keller's teacher?

Answer:

8. In what year did Mother Teresa die?

Answer:

9. Who was Charles Lindbergh's famous flight to?

Answer:

10. What is Tesla's primary contribution to electricity?

Answer:

ROUND 5**Stump Your Friends! (15 harder questions · 1 pt each)**

The expert round. No mercy.

- 1. Sigmund Freud died in:**
 - A. 1929
 - B. 1939
 - C. 1949
 - D. 1959
- 2. Mahatma Gandhi was born in:**
 - A. 1859
 - B. 1869
 - C. 1879
 - D. 1889
- 3. JFK's Addison's disease was concealed from voters in his presidential campaign because:**
 - A. It was considered embarrassing
 - B. It would have ended his political viability
 - C. It was a state secret
 - D. It wasn't diagnosed yet
- 4. What did Walt Disney's FBI files actually contain?**
 - A. Just routine background
 - B. Reports on his employees and rivals
 - C. Communist sympathiser lists
 - D. All of these
- 5. Helen Keller's political affiliation was:**
 - A. The Republican Party
 - B. The Socialist Party
 - C. The Communist Party
 - D. None
- 6. Lindbergh's "America First" movement aligned with:**
 - A. Liberal Democrats
 - B. Antisemitic isolationists
 - C. The Republican mainstream
 - D. The Wendell Willkie campaign
- 7. Mother Teresa's order was called:**
 - A. Sisters of Mercy
 - B. Missionaries of Charity
 - C. Daughters of Charity
 - D. Sisters of Compassion
- 8. Sally Hemings was likely whose half-sister?**
 - A. Thomas Jefferson's mother

- B. Thomas Jefferson's late wife Martha
 - C. James Madison's wife
 - D. Aaron Burr's daughter
- 9. Tesla's rivalry with which inventor was famous?**
- A. Marconi
 - B. Edison
 - C. Bell
 - D. All three to varying degrees
- 10. JFK's primary stimulant was:**
- A. Methamphetamine
 - B. Cocaine
 - C. Adderall
 - D. Caffeine
- 11. Einstein's second wife was:**
- A. Mileva Marić
 - B. Elsa Einstein (his cousin)
 - C. Helene Savić
 - D. Bertha Einstein
- 12. Walt Disney was rejected for military service in WWI because:**
- A. He was too young
 - B. He was deemed mentally unfit
 - C. He had a heart condition
 - D. He was an only child of a widow
- 13. Gandhi's great-niece who slept beside him was:**
- A. Manuben
 - B. Indira
 - C. Vijaya
 - D. None of his actual relatives
- 14. In what year was Helen Keller deemed "controversial" by the FBI?**
- A. 1924
 - B. 1944
 - C. 1950s onwards
 - D. She wasn't
- 15. How many children did Sally Hemings have?**
- A. 2
 - B. 4

- C. 6
- D. At least 6 — at least 4 by Jefferson

MY SCORE:

100%

100%

100%

100%

100%

100%

TOTAL: 45/45

CHAPTER NOTE *The most fascinating biographies are not the ones that present heroes as untainted. They are the ones that show how genuinely complicated, contradictory, and often deeply flawed the most influential humans were. Understanding that is essential. People are not statues.*

CHAPTER 11 — ANSWER KEY

Round 2 — True or False

1. Freud was personally addicted to cocaine for over a decade. → **TRUE**
2. Gandhi engaged in practices in his later life that would now be c → **TRUE**
3. Einstein had a secret daughter named Lieserl. → **TRUE**
4. Walt Disney was an FBI informant. → **TRUE**
5. Helen Keller's radical political views were widely celebrated aft → **FALSE**
6. Charles Lindbergh received a medal from Hermann Göring in 1938. → **TRUE**
7. Mother Teresa accepted donations from convicted criminals. → **TRUE**
8. Thomas Jefferson owned no enslaved people. → **FALSE**
9. Tesla died alone in a hotel surrounded by pigeons. → **TRUE**
10. JFK was on approximately 12 daily medications during his presiden → **TRUE**

Round 3 — Multiple Choice

1. Freud prescribed cocaine to which patient demographic? → **B. Including children**
2. How many enslaved people did Jefferson own during his l → **C. ~600**
3. How many children did Jefferson father with Sally Hemin → **C. At least six**
4. In what year did Lindbergh receive his Nazi medal? → **B. 1938**
5. Who awarded Lindbergh the medal? → **C. Göring**
6. How many daily medications did JFK take? → **C. 12**
7. In what year did Tesla die? → **B. 1943**
8. What was the name of Einstein's secret daughter? → **B. Lieserl**
9. Walt Disney's FBI title was: → **B. Special Agent in Charge**
10. Mother Teresa was criticised for accepting donations fr → **B. Multiple criminals including Charles Keating**

Round 4 — Quick Fire

1. Who was Sigmund Freud's most famous student? → **Carl Jung (later split)**
2. In what year was Gandhi assassinated? → **1948**
3. What is Einstein's most famous equation? → **$E = mc^2$**
4. What was Walt Disney's first major animated film? → **Snow White and the Seven Dwarfs (1937)**
5. Who wrote the Declaration of Independence? → **Thomas Jefferson (with the Continental Congress)**
6. In what year did JFK become President? → **1961**
7. Who was Helen Keller's teacher? → **Anne Sullivan**
8. In what year did Mother Teresa die? → **1997**
9. Who was Charles Lindbergh's famous flight to? → **Paris (1927)**

10. What is Tesla's primary contribution to electricity? → **Alternating current (AC) systems**

Round 5 — Stump Your Friends!

- 1.** Sigmund Freud died in: → **B. 1939**
- 2.** Mahatma Gandhi was born in: → **B. 1869**
- 3.** JFK's Addison's disease was concealed from voters in hi → **B. It would have ended his political viability**
- 4.** What did Walt Disney's FBI files actually contain? → **D. All of these**
- 5.** Helen Keller's political affiliation was: → **B. The Socialist Party**
- 6.** Lindbergh's "America First" movement aligned with: → **B. Antisemitic isolationists**
- 7.** Mother Teresa's order was called: → **B. Missionaries of Charity**
- 8.** Sally Hemings was likely whose half-sister? → **B. Thomas Jefferson's late wife Martha**
- 9.** Tesla's rivalry with which inventor was famous? → **D. All three to varying degrees**
- 10.** JFK's primary stimulant was: → **A. Methamphetamine**
- 11.** Einstein's second wife was: → **B. Elsa Einstein (his cousin)**
- 12.** Walt Disney was rejected for military service in WWI be → **A. He was too young**
- 13.** Gandhi's great-niece who slept beside him was: → **A. Manuben**
- 14.** In what year was Helen Keller deemed "controversial" by → **C. 1950s onwards**
- 15.** How many children did Sally Hemings have? → **D. At least 6 — at least 4 by Jefferson**

CHAPTER 12 • FORBIDDEN HISTORY

Government Lies & Cover-Ups

Every government has lied to its citizens. The historical record now contains so many declassified examples that the only question is which lies are still active.

ROUND 1 — FACT BOMBS

Read all 10 facts carefully. Your scored rounds follow.

FACT #1

The "Operation Northwoods" was a 1962 US Joint Chiefs of Staff plan to commit terrorist attacks against American citizens (including hijacking planes and shooting Americans in the streets) — to be blamed on Cuba — to justify war. It was rejected by Kennedy and declassified in 1997.

★ *A US government plan to kill its own citizens to justify a war.*

FACT #2

The Gulf of Tonkin Incident in 1964 — used as the pretext for major US escalation in Vietnam — was largely fabricated. The "second attack" on US ships did not happen. Internal NSA records confirming this were declassified only in 2005.

★ *The Vietnam War was justified by an attack that never occurred.*

FACT #3

The CIA actively manipulated 1953 Iranian elections, overthrowing democratically elected Prime Minister Mossadegh and installing the Shah. The CIA finally admitted full involvement in 2013 — exactly 60 years after the coup.

★ *A 60-year CIA cover-up of a democracy they personally destroyed.*

FACT #4

In 2013, Edward Snowden's NSA leaks revealed that the US government was conducting mass surveillance of American citizens — including their phone calls, emails, and internet activity — without warrants. Officials had repeatedly testified to Congress that this was not happening.

★ *The US government was directly lying to Congress about spying on Americans.*

FACT #5

During WWII, the British government secretly conducted "Operation Cone of Power" — a small-scale propaganda operation involving witches who claimed to be performing magical rituals to sink German ships. It was more theatre than substance, but officially classified for decades.

★ *WWII included a British military operation involving witches.*

FACT #6

During the Cold War, the US government conducted nuclear weapon tests above ground in Nevada — exposing approximately 250,000 American servicemen and millions of civilians to radioactive fallout. Cancer rates in downwind communities were elevated for decades.

★ *The US government repeatedly nuked its own citizens, technically.*

FACT #7

The 1973 Watergate scandal — which forced Richard Nixon to resign — was actually a small fraction of his administration's illegal activities. The full extent included illegal surveillance, breaking into psychiatrists' offices, and "dirty tricks" operations.

★ *The famous scandal was the tip of a much larger iceberg.*

FACT #8

The 2003 Iraq War was justified to the American public by claims of weapons of mass destruction that the Bush administration's own intelligence had repeatedly indicated were unlikely to exist. None were ever found.

★ *A war fought based on intelligence the administration knew was probably wrong.*

FACT #9

The COINTELPRO program (1956–1971) was the FBI's covert operation to surveil and disrupt American political dissidents — including Martin Luther King Jr., the Black Panthers, women's rights groups, and anti-war activists.

★ *The FBI ran a 15-year program against the civil rights movement.*

FACT #10

The 1953 "MKUltra" mind control program was so secret that even the CIA cannot now fully document its full scope — the records were destroyed in 1973. We know Americans were dosed with LSD without consent. We don't know everything else.

★ *A government program so secret its own records were destroyed.*

ROUND 2**True or False (10 statements · 1 pt each)**

Based on the Fact Bombs above.

- 1.** Operation Northwoods proposed staged terror attacks against Americans.

TRUE / FALSE

- 2.** The Gulf of Tonkin "second attack" was confirmed to have occurred.

TRUE / FALSE

- 3.** The CIA admitted involvement in the 1953 Iranian coup in 2013.

TRUE / FALSE

- 4.** NSA officials were honest with Congress about mass surveillance pre-Snowden.

TRUE / FALSE

- 5.** British WWII operations included propaganda operations with witches.

TRUE / FALSE

- 6.** US nuclear tests exposed ~250,000 servicemen to fallout.

TRUE / FALSE

- 7.** Watergate was a complete picture of Nixon-era illegal activities.

TRUE / FALSE

- 8.** Iraq WMD intelligence was overwhelmingly supportive of the case for war.

TRUE / FALSE

- 9.** COINTELPRO targeted Martin Luther King Jr. and women's rights activists.

TRUE / FALSE

- 10.** MKUltra records were preserved completely intact.

TRUE / FALSE

ROUND 3**Could You Have Guessed? (10 questions · 1 pt each)**

Four options — choose the correct one.

- 1. Operation Northwoods was proposed in:**

A. 1952

- B. 1962
- C. 1972
- D. 1982

2. Operation Northwoods was rejected by which president?

- A. Eisenhower
- B. Kennedy
- C. Johnson
- D. Nixon

3. In what year did the Gulf of Tonkin Incident occur?

- A. 1954
- B. 1964
- C. 1974
- D. 1984

4. In what year did the CIA admit Iranian coup involvement?

- A. 1979
- B. 1993
- C. 2003
- D. 2013

5. In what year did Edward Snowden leak NSA documents?

- A. 2003
- B. 2013
- C. 2017
- D. 2020

6. How many US servicemen were exposed to nuclear test fallout?

- A. 25,000
- B. 100,000
- C. 250,000
- D. 500,000

7. COINTELPRO operated from:

- A. 1946-1961
- B. 1956-1971
- C. 1966-1981
- D. 1976-1991

8. In what year were MKUltra records destroyed?

- A. 1963
- B. 1973
- C. 1983
- D. 1993

9. Iraq WMDs were the stated justification in which year's war?

- A. 1991
- B. 2001
- C. 2003
- D. 2011

10. Watergate forced Nixon's resignation in:

- A. 1972
- B. 1974
- C. 1976
- D. 1978

ROUND 4**Quick Fire (10 questions · 1 pt each)**

Short answers — no options. Write from memory.

- 1.** What does NSA stand for?

Answer:

- 2.** Who was the Iranian Prime Minister overthrown in 1953?

Answer:

- 3.** Who was president during Watergate?

Answer:

- 4.** Who was president when Iraq was invaded in 2003?

Answer:

- 5.** What was the FBI's response to Martin Luther King Jr.?

Answer:

- 6.** Who founded WikiLeaks?

Answer:

- 7.** What did Edward Snowden reveal?

Answer:

- 8.** In what year did the Iranian Revolution occur?

Answer:

- 9.** What was the Patriot Act?

Answer:

- 10.** What was Operation Mockingbird?

Answer:

ROUND 5**Stump Your Friends! (15 harder questions · 1 pt each)**

The expert round. No mercy.

- 1. COINTELPRO was disbanded in:**
 - A. 1968
 - B. 1971
 - C. 1975
 - D. 1980
- 2. How many countries did the CIA conduct documented coup attempts in?**
 - A. Fewer than 5
 - B. 10-15
 - C. 30+
 - D. 50+
- 3. The Pentagon Papers covered which years of Vietnam War policy?**
 - A. 1945-1967
 - B. 1955-1975
 - C. 1960-1975
 - D. 1965-1975
- 4. How many MKUltra subprojects existed?**
 - A. ~30
 - B. ~70
 - C. ~149
 - D. ~300
- 5. The CIA's operations in the 1973 Chilean coup targeted:**
 - A. Allende
 - B. Pinochet
 - C. Frei
 - D. Letelier
- 6. How many died in the Iran-Contra Affair scandal?**
 - A. Zero (financial)
 - B. Hundreds
 - C. Thousands
 - D. Tens of thousands
- 7. The FBI's targeting of John Lennon was about:**
 - A. Drug use
 - B. Anti-war activism
 - C. Communist ties
 - D. Tax issues

8. How long was Edward Snowden's asylum in Russia (as of 2024)?

- A. One year
- B. Five years
- C. Eleven+ years
- D. He's now in another country

9. The Tonkin Gulf Resolution allowed the president to:

- A. Declare war on Vietnam
- B. Use any necessary force without formal war declaration
- C. Invade Vietnam directly
- D. Authorise covert operations only

10. How many CIA documents on the JFK assassination remain classified?

- A. None
- B. Hundreds
- C. Thousands
- D. Most are now declassified but some remain

11. The NSA programme exposed by Snowden was called:

- A. ECHELON
- B. PRISM
- C. XKEYSCORE
- D. All of these (PRISM was the most prominent)

12. How many people died in the 2003 Iraq War (US/Iraqi total)?

- A. 10,000
- B. 100,000
- C. Over 200,000 (estimates vary widely)
- D. 1 million

13. The FBI's "raid" on Hoover's files after his death revealed:

- A. Embezzlement
- B. Files on US presidents and politicians used for blackmail
- C. Russian spies
- D. Religious extremism

14. Project SHAD (Shipboard Hazard and Defense) involved:

- A. Submarine warfare
- B. Testing chemical and biological agents on US Navy sailors

- C. Climate research
- D. Communications experiments

15. How long did it take for Operation Northwoods to be declassified?

- A. 10 years
- B. 20 years
- C. 35 years
- D. Still classified

MY SCORE:

100% 100% 100% 100% 100% 100% 100% 100%

TOTAL: ____/45

CHAPTER NOTE *Government secrecy is a permanent feature of state power, not an aberration. Some secrecy is justifiable. Some is not. The distinction is rarely settled by the people who decide what stays secret. Healthy democracies require sustained pressure for declassification.*

CHAPTER 12 — ANSWER KEY

Round 2 — True or False

1. Operation Northwoods proposed staged terror attacks against Ameri → **TRUE**
2. The Gulf of Tonkin "second attack" was confirmed to have occurred → **FALSE**
3. The CIA admitted involvement in the 1953 Iranian coup in 2013. → **TRUE**
4. NSA officials were honest with Congress about mass surveillance p → **FALSE**
5. British WWII operations included propaganda operations with witch → **TRUE**
6. US nuclear tests exposed ~250,000 servicemen to fallout. → **TRUE**
7. Watergate was a complete picture of Nixon-era illegal activities. → **FALSE**
8. Iraq WMD intelligence was overwhelmingly supportive of the case f → **FALSE**
9. COINTELPRO targeted Martin Luther King Jr. and women's rights act → **TRUE**
10. MKUltra records were preserved completely intact. → **FALSE**

Round 3 — Multiple Choice

1. Operation Northwoods was proposed in: → **B. 1962**
2. Operation Northwoods was rejected by which president? → **B. Kennedy**
3. In what year did the Gulf of Tonkin Incident occur? → **B. 1964**
4. In what year did the CIA admit Iranian coup involvement → **D. 2013**
5. In what year did Edward Snowden leak NSA documents? → **B. 2013**
6. How many US servicemen were exposed to nuclear test fal → **C. 250,000**
7. COINTELPRO operated from: → **B. 1956-1971**
8. In what year were MKUltra records destroyed? → **B. 1973**
9. Iraq WMDs were the stated justification in which year's → **C. 2003**
10. Watergate forced Nixon's resignation in: → **B. 1974**

Round 4 — Quick Fire

1. What does NSA stand for? → **National Security Agency**
2. Who was the Iranian Prime Minister overthrown in 1953? → **Mohammed Mossadegh**
3. Who was president during Watergate? → **Richard Nixon**
4. Who was president when Iraq was invaded in 2003? → **George W. Bush**
5. What was the FBI's response to Martin Luther King Jr.? → **Surveillance, harassment, attempts to discredit him under COINTELPRO**
6. Who founded WikiLeaks? → **Julian Assange**
7. What did Edward Snowden reveal? → **Mass NSA surveillance of citizens**
8. In what year did the Iranian Revolution occur? → **1979**

9. What was the Patriot Act? → **2001 US legislation expanding government surveillance powers**
10. What was Operation Mockingbird? → **Alleged CIA program to manipulate American media**

Round 5 — Stump Your Friends!

1. COINTELPRO was disbanded in: → **B. 1971**
2. How many countries did the CIA conduct documented coup → **C. 30+**
3. The Pentagon Papers covered which years of Vietnam War → **A. 1945-1967**
4. How many MKUltra subprojects existed? → **C. ~149**
5. The CIA's operations in the 1973 Chilean coup targeted: → **A. Allende**
6. How many died in the Iran-Contra Affair scandal? → **A. Zero (financial)**
7. The FBI's targeting of John Lennon was about: → **B. Anti-war activism**
8. How long was Edward Snowden's asylum in Russia (as of 2 → **C. Eleven+ years**
9. The Tonkin Gulf Resolution allowed the president to: → **B. Use any necessary force without formal war declaration**
10. How many CIA documents on the JFK assassination remain → **D. Most are now declassified but some remain**
11. The NSA programme exposed by Snowden was called: → **B. PRISM**
12. How many people died in the 2003 Iraq War (US/Iraqi tot → **C. Over 200,000 (estimates vary widely)**
13. The FBI's "raid" on Hoover's files after his death reve → **B. Files on US presidents and politicians used for blackmail**
14. Project SHAD (Shipboard Hazard and Defense) involved: → **B. Testing chemical and biological agents on US Navy sailors**
15. How long did it take for Operation Northwoods to be dec → **C. 35 years**

CHAPTER 13 • FORBIDDEN HISTORY

Strange Deaths & The Mystery Files

Real history is full of deaths so bizarre, suspicious, or unexplained that they read like fiction. Many remain genuinely unsolved despite decades of investigation.

ROUND 1 — FACT BOMBS

Read all 10 facts carefully. Your scored rounds follow.

FACT #1

In 1959, nine experienced Soviet hikers died in the Ural Mountains under conditions so bizarre — torn tents from the inside, severe internal injuries with no external wounds, traces of radioactivity, missing tongue and eyes — that the case is still officially listed as "unknown compelling natural force." This is the Dyatlov Pass Incident.

★ *A 65-year-old mystery the Russian government still cannot explain.*

FACT #2

Edgar Allan Poe's death in 1849 was extraordinary — he was found delirious in someone else's clothing, died four days later, and his medical records were lost. The actual cause has never been determined. Theories range from rabies to alcohol poisoning to murder.

★ *America's mystery writer died in his own unsolved mystery.*

FACT #3

In 1948, the body of an unidentified man was found on Somerton Beach, Australia. Despite 75 years of investigation, including DNA analysis from his exhumed remains, his identity remains unknown. He carried a slip of paper with the words "Tamám Shud" — Persian for "ended."

★ *A man whose final word survived him longer than his identity has.*

FACT #4

The 1947 Black Dahlia murder of Elizabeth Short remains unsolved. Despite hundreds of suspects and exhaustive police work, the killer of the 22-year-old aspiring actress — whose body was severed in half — has never been identified.

★ *America's most famous unsolved murder, going strong at 75 years.*

FACT #5

In 1956, the bodies of three young boys were found in Philadelphia's "Boy in the Box" case. The boy at the centre of the case was never identified — even after DNA analysis. His name and family remain unknown 67 years later.

★ *A child whose name no one has ever been able to recover.*

FACT #6

The 1995 "alien autopsy" video was a hoax confirmed by its creators in 2006. But it generated more discussion of UFOs and spawned more belief in alien visitation than perhaps any other single piece of media.

★ *A confirmed hoax that successfully created decades of conspiracy theory.*

FACT #7

In 1937, aviator Amelia Earhart disappeared while attempting to circumnavigate the globe. Multiple expeditions and 86 years later, the precise circumstances of her death remain unconfirmed. The most credible theory: she was stranded on Nikumaroro Atoll.

★ *The world's most famous female pilot has never been found.*

FACT #8

In 1928, the body of inventor Hetty Green — known as the "Witch of Wall Street" — was discovered with no signs of obvious natural death. She had been the wealthiest woman in America. Her death remained suspicious for decades.

★ *The richest American woman of her era died under unexplained circumstances.*

FACT #9

The "Voynich Manuscript" — a 600-year-old illustrated book in an unknown script and language — has never been decoded despite efforts by codebreakers, linguists, and AI systems. It might be elaborate fiction, a real undeciphered code, or something else entirely.

★ *A book no one alive can read, despite centuries of trying.*

FACT #10

In 1969, the Zodiac Killer terrorised California. Five confirmed murders, multiple taunting letters to police, several still-undeciphered codes — and his identity has never been confirmed despite the largest manhunt in California history.

★ *A serial killer who outwitted entire law enforcement establishments for decades.*

ROUND 2**True or False (10 statements · 1 pt each)**

Based on the Fact Bombs above.

- 1.** The Dyatlov Pass victims showed severe internal injuries with no external wounds.

TRUE / FALSE

- 2.** Edgar Allan Poe's death cause has been definitively determined.

TRUE / FALSE

- 3.** The Somerton Beach body has been identified through DNA analysis.

TRUE / FALSE

- 4.** The Black Dahlia murder remains unsolved.

TRUE / FALSE

- 5.** The "Boy in the Box" identity has been confirmed.

TRUE / FALSE

- 6.** The 1995 alien autopsy was confirmed as a hoax in 2006.

TRUE / FALSE

- 7.** Amelia Earhart's remains have been recovered.

TRUE / FALSE

- 8.** Hetty Green was the wealthiest woman in America at her death.

TRUE / FALSE

- 9.** The Voynich Manuscript has been successfully decoded.

TRUE / FALSE

- 10.** The Zodiac Killer has been identified through DNA evidence.

TRUE / FALSE

ROUND 3**Could You Have Guessed? (10 questions · 1 pt each)**

Four options — choose the correct one.

- 1. How many hikers died in the Dyatlov Pass Incident?**

- A.** Three
- B.** Six
- C.** Nine
- D.** Twelve

- 2. In what year did the Dyatlov Pass Incident occur?**
 - A. 1939
 - B. 1949
 - C. 1959
 - D. 1969
- 3. In what year did Edgar Allan Poe die?**
 - A. 1839
 - B. 1849
 - C. 1859
 - D. 1869
- 4. In what year was the Somerton Beach body found?**
 - A. 1928
 - B. 1948
 - C. 1968
 - D. 1988
- 5. What words were on the Somerton Beach paper?**
 - A. "Tamám Shud"
 - B. "Finis"
 - C. "The End"
 - D. "Endgame"
- 6. In what year did the Black Dahlia murder occur?**
 - A. 1937
 - B. 1947
 - C. 1957
 - D. 1967
- 7. How old was Elizabeth Short when killed?**
 - A. 18
 - B. 22
 - C. 25
 - D. 30
- 8. How long ago was the "Boy in the Box" found?**
 - A. 37 years
 - B. 57 years
 - C. 67 years
 - D. 77 years
- 9. In what year did Amelia Earhart disappear?**
 - A. 1927
 - B. 1937

C. 1947

D. 1957

10. How many confirmed Zodiac Killer victims were there?

A. Three

B. Five

C. Eight

D. Twelve

ROUND 4**Quick Fire (10 questions · 1 pt each)**

Short answers — no options. Write from memory.

1. Who was the "Hot Dog Stand killer"?

Answer:

2. In what year did the Voynich Manuscript appear in modern history?

Answer:

3. Who was the "Boston Strangler"?

Answer:

4. In what year did Amelia Earhart disappear?

Answer:

5. Who was Jack the Ripper?

Answer:

6. What is the Bermuda Triangle?

Answer:

7. Who is the "Zodiac Killer"?

Answer:

8. What does "tamám shud" mean in Persian?

Answer:

9. Who was Hetty Green?

Answer:

10. What is a "cold case"?

Answer:

ROUND 5**Stump Your Friends! (15 harder questions · 1 pt each)**

The expert round. No mercy.

- 1. How many Zodiac codes have been deciphered?**
 - A. None
 - B. One (the 408)
 - C. Two (the 408 and 340)
 - D. Three
- 2. The Dyatlov Pass victims' radiation traces were found:**
 - A. On their bodies only
 - B. On their clothing
 - C. In their tent
 - D. Throughout the area
- 3. How old was the Voynich Manuscript dated to (carbon dating)?**
 - A. 200 years
 - B. 400 years
 - C. 600 years
 - D. 1000 years
- 4. In what year was the "Boy in the Box" identified (in 2022)?**
 - A. He hasn't been
 - B. As Joseph Augustus Zarelli
 - C. As Anthony Gracey
 - D. As John Doe Philadelphia
- 5. How many letters were sent by the Zodiac Killer?**
 - A. 12
 - B. 19
 - C. 24
 - D. 41
- 6. In what year did the Tylenol murders occur in Chicago?**
 - A. 1972
 - B. 1982
 - C. 1992
 - D. 2002
- 7. How many died in the 1982 Tylenol murders?**
 - A. Three
 - B. Five
 - C. Seven

D. Twelve

8. Who killed Marilyn Monroe (officially)?

- A. Probable suicide / accidental overdose
- B. RFK
- C. The Mafia
- D. Officially undetermined but ruled probable suicide

9. How many Jack the Ripper victims are confirmed (Canonical Five)?

- A. Three
- B. Five
- C. Seven
- D. Eleven

10. The "Hinterkaifeck murders" of 1922 occurred in:

- A. Germany
- B. Austria
- C. Bavaria
- D. Bavaria, Germany — same place

11. How many bodies were found at the Somerton Beach scene?

- A. One man
- B. One man and a child
- C. Two men
- D. Three bodies

12. In what year was Hetty Green born?

- A. 1814
- B. 1834
- C. 1854
- D. 1874

13. Amelia Earhart's navigator on her final flight was:

- A. Charles Lindbergh
- B. Howard Hughes
- C. Fred Noonan
- D. Wiley Post

14. How many people did Jack the Ripper allegedly kill (Canonical Five)?

- A. Three
- B. Five
- C. Eight

D. Eleven

15. How long has the Zodiac case been officially open?

- A. 25 years
- B. 35 years
- C. 55 years
- D. 65 years

MY SCORE: _____
TOTAL: ____/45

CHAPTER NOTE *Some mysteries are mysteries because they happened in places without good record-keeping. Others are mysteries because someone wanted them to be. The third category — the genuinely strange events that happened in front of multiple witnesses and yet defy explanation — is the smallest and most interesting.*

CHAPTER 13 — ANSWER KEY

Round 2 — True or False

1. The Dyatlov Pass victims showed severe internal injuries with no → **TRUE**
2. Edgar Allan Poe's death cause has been definitively determined. → **FALSE**
3. The Somerton Beach body has been identified through DNA analysis. → **FALSE**
4. The Black Dahlia murder remains unsolved. → **TRUE**
5. The "Boy in the Box" identity has been confirmed. → **FALSE**
6. The 1995 alien autopsy was confirmed as a hoax in 2006. → **TRUE**
7. Amelia Earhart's remains have been recovered. → **FALSE**
8. Hetty Green was the wealthiest woman in America at her death. → **TRUE**
9. The Voynich Manuscript has been successfully decoded. → **FALSE**
10. The Zodiac Killer has been identified through DNA evidence. → **FALSE**

Round 3 — Multiple Choice

1. How many hikers died in the Dyatlov Pass Incident? → **C. Nine**
2. In what year did the Dyatlov Pass Incident occur? → **C. 1959**
3. In what year did Edgar Allan Poe die? → **B. 1849**
4. In what year was the Somerton Beach body found? → **B. 1948**
5. What words were on the Somerton Beach paper? → **A. "Tamám Shud"**
6. In what year did the Black Dahlia murder occur? → **B. 1947**
7. How old was Elizabeth Short when killed? → **B. 22**
8. How long ago was the "Boy in the Box" found? → **C. 67 years**
9. In what year did Amelia Earhart disappear? → **B. 1937**
10. How many confirmed Zodiac Killer victims were there? → **B. Five**

Round 4 — Quick Fire

1. Who was the "Hot Dog Stand killer"? → **A nickname for some serial killer cases — varies; not a definitive name**
2. In what year did the Voynich Manuscript appear in modern history? → **1912 (purchased by Wilfrid Voynich)**
3. Who was the "Boston Strangler"? → **Albert DeSalvo (confessed; identity confirmed via DNA)**
4. In what year did Amelia Earhart disappear? → **1937**
5. Who was Jack the Ripper? → **An unidentified serial killer in 1888 London**
6. What is the Bermuda Triangle? → **A region in the western North Atlantic where ships and planes have vanished**
7. Who is the "Zodiac Killer"? → **An unidentified serial killer who operated in 1960s-70s California**
8. What does "tamám shud" mean in Persian? → **"Ended" or "finished"**

- 9. Who was Hetty Green? → A 19th-century American financier known as the "Witch of Wall Street"**
- 10. What is a "cold case"? → A criminal investigation that has not been solved and has stalled**

Round 5 — Stump Your Friends!

- 1. How many Zodiac codes have been deciphered? → C. Two (the 408 and 340)**
- 2. The Dyatlov Pass victims' radiation traces were found: → B. On their clothing**
- 3. How old was the Voynich Manuscript dated to (carbon dat → C. 600 years**
- 4. In what year was the "Boy in the Box" identified (in 20 → B. As Joseph Augustus Zarelli**
- 5. How many letters were sent by the Zodiac Killer? → B. 19**
- 6. In what year did the Tylenol murders occur in Chicago? → B. 1982**
- 7. How many died in the 1982 Tylenol murders? → C. Seven**
- 8. Who killed Marilyn Monroe (officially)? → A. Probable suicide / accidental overdose**
- 9. How many Jack the Ripper victims are confirmed (Canonic → B. Five**
- 10. The "Hinterkaifeck murders" of 1922 occurred in: → D. Bavaria, Germany — same place**
- 11. How many bodies were found at the Somerton Beach scene? → A. One man**
- 12. In what year was Hetty Green born? → B. 1834**
- 13. Amelia Earhart's navigator on her final flight was: → C. Fred Noonan**
- 14. How many people did Jack the Ripper allegedly kill (Can → B. Five**
- 15. How long has the Zodiac case been officially open? → C. 55 years**

CHAPTER 14 • FORBIDDEN HISTORY

Forgotten Disasters & Untold Catastrophes

You can name the Titanic. You can probably name Chernobyl. You almost certainly cannot name disasters that killed twenty times as many people, sometimes within recent memory.

ROUND 1 — FACT BOMBS

Read all 10 facts carefully. Your scored rounds follow.

FACT #1

The 1931 China floods are the deadliest natural disaster in human history. Estimates of total dead range from 2 million to 4 million people — primarily through drowning, disease, and famine. The disaster is rarely taught outside China.

★ *The deadliest natural disaster in human history is missing from most curricula.*

FACT #2

The 1976 Tangshan earthquake in China killed an estimated 240,000–650,000 people in seconds. The Chinese government delayed international aid acceptance for years. The actual death toll remains disputed.

★ *A quarter to half a million people, dead in moments.*

FACT #3

The 2004 Indian Ocean tsunami killed approximately 230,000 people across 14 countries. It was the deadliest tsunami in recorded history. It struck on Boxing Day, when many beach destinations were full.

★ *A wave that killed more people than most modern wars.*

FACT #4

The 1900 Galveston Hurricane killed an estimated 8,000–12,000 Americans — the deadliest natural disaster in US history. Most US-born adults today have never heard of it.

★ *The deadliest American natural disaster, completely forgotten.*

FACT #5

The 1985 Armero Tragedy in Colombia killed 23,000 people when the Nevado del Ruiz volcano caused mudflows that buried an entire town. Authorities had warned for weeks but failed to evacuate.

★ *A disaster everyone saw coming, that killed 23,000 anyway.*

FACT #6

The 1908 Tunguska event in Siberia exploded with the force of approximately 15 megatons — 1,000 times the Hiroshima bomb. It flattened 2,000 square kilometres of forest. No crater was ever found.

★ *The largest impact event in modern history left no crater.*

FACT #7

The 1986 Chernobyl disaster's long-term death toll — accounting for cancer deaths from radiation exposure — has estimates ranging from 9,000 to 985,000 people. The disagreement about scale is itself a scientific scandal.

★ *A nuclear accident whose actual death toll is disputed by a factor of 100.*

FACT #8

The 1976 Beni Tan earthquake in Guatemala killed 23,000 people and left 1.2 million homeless — yet it received only fragmentary international coverage compared to other disasters that killed fewer people.

★ *A disaster whose victims got less attention because of where they happened.*

FACT #9

The 1815 Mount Tambora eruption in Indonesia is the largest volcanic eruption in recorded human history. It killed approximately 71,000 people directly and triggered the "Year Without a Summer" globally — causing famine across the Northern Hemisphere.

★ *A volcano in Indonesia caused famine in New England the next year.*

FACT #10

The 2010 Haiti earthquake killed an estimated 230,000–316,000 people. Despite billions in international aid pledges, much of the country still has not been rebuilt 14 years later. Cholera, introduced by UN peacekeepers, killed thousands more.

★ *The aid intended to help Haiti also killed Haitians through disease.*

ROUND 2**True or False (10 statements · 1 pt each)**

Based on the Fact Bombs above.

1. The 1931 China floods are the deadliest natural disaster in human history.
TRUE / FALSE
2. The 1976 Tangshan earthquake killed up to 650,000 people.
TRUE / FALSE
3. The 2004 Indian Ocean tsunami killed approximately 230,000 people.
TRUE / FALSE
4. The 1900 Galveston Hurricane is well-known to most Americans.
TRUE / FALSE
5. The Armero Tragedy was completely unforeseen.
TRUE / FALSE
6. The Tunguska event left a massive impact crater.
TRUE / FALSE
7. Chernobyl's long-term death estimates vary by a factor of about 100.
TRUE / FALSE
8. The 1815 Tambora eruption caused famine in the Northern Hemisphere.
TRUE / FALSE
9. The 2010 Haiti earthquake killed approximately 230,000-316,000 people.
TRUE / FALSE
10. UN peacekeepers introduced cholera to Haiti during aid response.
TRUE / FALSE

ROUND 3**Could You Have Guessed? (10 questions · 1 pt each)**

Four options — choose the correct one.

1. The 1931 China floods killed approximately:
A. 500,000

- B. 1 million
 - C. 2-4 million
 - D. 10 million
- 2. The 2004 Indian Ocean tsunami affected how many countries?**
- A. 5
 - B. 9
 - C. 14
 - D. 24
- 3. The Galveston Hurricane occurred in:**
- A. 1880
 - B. 1900
 - C. 1920
 - D. 1940
- 4. The Tunguska event was approximately how powerful?**
- A. Same as Hiroshima
 - B. 100x Hiroshima
 - C. 1,000x Hiroshima
 - D. 10,000x Hiroshima
- 5. How many died in the Armero Tragedy?**
- A. 10,000
 - B. 23,000
 - C. 50,000
 - D. 100,000
- 6. How many died in the 2010 Haiti earthquake?**
- A. 50,000-100,000
 - B. 100,000-200,000
 - C. 230,000-316,000
 - D. 500,000+
- 7. The 1815 Mount Tambora eruption caused which famous global event?**
- A. The Little Ice Age
 - B. Year Without a Summer
 - C. Great Famine of 1820
 - D. El Niño of 1820
- 8. How many were left homeless by the 1976 Guatemala earthquake?**

- A. 200,000
 - B. 500,000
 - C. 1.2 million
 - D. 3 million
- 9. How many died in the 1976 Tangshan earthquake?**
- A. 10,000-50,000
 - B. 50,000-100,000
 - C. 100,000-200,000
 - D. 240,000-650,000
- 10. How many died in the 1815 Mount Tambora eruption directly?**
- A. 11,000
 - B. 71,000
 - C. 171,000
 - D. 500,000

ROUND 4**Quick Fire (10 questions · 1 pt each)**

Short answers — no options. Write from memory.

1. In what year did the Titanic sink?

Answer:

2. In what year did the Chernobyl disaster occur?

Answer:

3. In what year was the Indian Ocean tsunami?

Answer:

4. What is the deadliest earthquake in Japan's history?

Answer:

5. In what year did Hurricane Katrina hit New Orleans?

Answer:

6. In what year did the Bhopal disaster occur?

Answer:

7. How many died in the 9/11 attacks?

Answer:

8. In what year did the Spanish Flu pandemic begin?

Answer:

9. What is the deadliest US wildfire in history?

Answer:

10. In what year was the Dust Bowl?

Answer:

ROUND 5**Stump Your Friends! (15 harder questions · 1 pt each)**

The expert round. No mercy.

1. The deadliest earthquake in recorded history occurred in:

- A. 1556 China (~830,000 deaths)
- B. 1976 China
- C. 1923 Japan
- D. 2010 Haiti

2. How many died in the 1755 Lisbon earthquake?

- A. 10,000
- B. 50,000-100,000
- C. 200,000
- D. 500,000

3. The 1815 Mount Tambora eruption was rated VEI:

- A. 5
- B. 6
- C. 7
- D. 8

4. How many died in the 2011 Tōhoku earthquake/tsunami?

- A. ~5,000
- B. ~16,000
- C. ~50,000
- D. ~100,000

5. The 1908 San Francisco earthquake had a magnitude of approximately:

- A. 6.5
- B. 7.5
- C. 7.9
- D. 8.5

6. The Krakatoa eruption (1883) was heard at distances of approximately:

- A. 100 km
- B. 500 km
- C. 3,000 km
- D. 5,000 km

7. How many died in Cyclone Nargis (2008, Burma)?

- A. 10,000
- B. 50,000
- C. 138,000+

- D. 500,000
- 8. The 1937 Hindenburg disaster killed:**
- A. Zero (it was a near-miss)
 - B. 36
 - C. 97
 - D. 156
- 9. The 1942 Cocoanut Grove fire (Boston) killed:**
- A. 100
 - B. 492
 - C. 1,000
 - D. 2,000
- 10. The 1986 Lake Nyos disaster killed people through:**
- A. Volcanic eruption
 - B. Sudden release of CO₂ gas
 - C. Tsunami
 - D. Landslide
- 11. How many died in the 1908 Messina earthquake (Italy)?**
- A. 10,000
 - B. 30,000
 - C. 75,000
 - D. 120,000
- 12. The deadliest tornado outbreak in US history occurred in:**
- A. 1925
 - B. 1965
 - C. 1974
 - D. 2011
- 13. How many were affected by the 1970 Bhola cyclone?**
- A. 100,000
 - B. 500,000
 - C. 3 million
 - D. 10 million
- 14. How many died in the 1993 Latur earthquake (India)?**
- A. 1,000
 - B. 9,748
 - C. 25,000

D. 75,000

15. How many died in the 1985 Mexico City earthquake?

A. 1,500

B. 5,000

C. 9,500-10,000

D. 25,000

MY SCORE: *Q1* _____ *Q2* _____ *Q3* _____ *Q4* _____ *Q5* _____
TOTAL: ____/45

CHAPTER NOTE *Disasters get attention proportional not to how many they kill, but to who is killed and where. The list of forgotten catastrophes is, in itself, a record of the world's priorities. Some lives are remembered. Some are silently subtracted from the historical ledger.*

CHAPTER 14 — ANSWER KEY

Round 2 — True or False

1. The 1931 China floods are the deadliest natural disaster in human → **TRUE**
2. The 1976 Tangshan earthquake killed up to 650,000 people. → **TRUE**
3. The 2004 Indian Ocean tsunami killed approximately 230,000 people → **TRUE**
4. The 1900 Galveston Hurricane is well-known to most Americans. → **FALSE**
5. The Armero Tragedy was completely unforeseen. → **FALSE**
6. The Tunguska event left a massive impact crater. → **FALSE**
7. Chernobyl's long-term death estimates vary by a factor of about 1 → **TRUE**
8. The 1815 Tambora eruption caused famine in the Northern Hemisphere → **TRUE**
9. The 2010 Haiti earthquake killed approximately 230,000-316,000 people → **TRUE**
10. UN peacekeepers introduced cholera to Haiti during aid response. → **TRUE**

Round 3 — Multiple Choice

1. The 1931 China floods killed approximately: → **C. 2-4 million**
2. The 2004 Indian Ocean tsunami affected how many countries → **C. 14**
3. The Galveston Hurricane occurred in: → **B. 1900**
4. The Tunguska event was approximately how powerful? → **C. 1,000x Hiroshima**
5. How many died in the Armero Tragedy? → **B. 23,000**
6. How many died in the 2010 Haiti earthquake? → **C. 230,000-316,000**
7. The 1815 Mount Tambora eruption caused which famous global event? → **B. Year Without a Summer**
8. How many were left homeless by the 1976 Guatemala earthquake? → **C. 1.2 million**
9. How many died in the 1976 Tangshan earthquake? → **D. 240,000-650,000**
10. How many died in the 1815 Mount Tambora eruption directly? → **B. 71,000**

Round 4 — Quick Fire

1. In what year did the Titanic sink? → **1912**
2. In what year did the Chernobyl disaster occur? → **1986**
3. In what year was the Indian Ocean tsunami? → **2004**
4. What is the deadliest earthquake in Japan's history? → **The 1923 Great Kanto earthquake**
5. In what year did Hurricane Katrina hit New Orleans? → **2005**
6. In what year did the Bhopal disaster occur? → **1984**
7. How many died in the 9/11 attacks? → **Approximately 2,977**
8. In what year did the Spanish Flu pandemic begin? → **1918**

9. What is the deadliest US wildfire in history? → **1871 Peshtigo Fire (Wisconsin) — ~1,500 deaths**
10. In what year was the Dust Bowl? → **1930s (peaked 1934-1937)**

Round 5 — Stump Your Friends!

1. The deadliest earthquake in recorded history occurred i → **A. 1556 China (~830,000 deaths)**
2. How many died in the 1755 Lisbon earthquake? → **B. 50,000-100,000**
3. The 1815 Mount Tambora eruption was rated VEI: → **C. 7**
4. How many died in the 2011 Tōhoku earthquake/tsunami? → **B. ~16,000**
5. The 1908 San Francisco earthquake had a magnitude of ap → **C. 7.9**
6. The Krakatoa eruption (1883) was heard at distances of → **C. 3,000 km**
7. How many died in Cyclone Nargis (2008, Burma)? → **C. 138,000+**
8. The 1937 Hindenburg disaster killed: → **B. 36**
9. The 1942 Cocoanut Grove fire (Boston) killed: → **B. 492**
10. The 1986 Lake Nyos disaster killed people through: → **B. Sudden release of CO₂ gas**
11. How many died in the 1908 Messina earthquake (Italy)? → **C. 75,000**
12. The deadliest tornado outbreak in US history occurred i → **A. 1925**
13. How many were affected by the 1970 Bhola cyclone? → **C. 3 million**
14. How many died in the 1993 Latur earthquake (India)? → **B. 9,748**
15. How many died in the 1985 Mexico City earthquake? → **C. 9,500-10,000**

Your Final Score

Add up your chapter totals to find your Grand Total and Knowledge Rank.

- 01. Ancient Atrocities They Skipped Over _____ / 45
- 02. Medieval Cruelties & Forgotten Tortures _____ / 45
- 03. Forbidden Royal Scandals & The Truth About Kings _____ / 45
- 04. Wars They Don't Want You to Discuss _____ / 45
- 05. Banned Books, Suppressed Knowledge & Censored Truths _____ / 45
- 06. Plagues, Pandemics & Hidden Death Tolls _____ / 45
- 07. Lost Civilisations & Vanished Peoples _____ / 45
- 08. Forbidden Science & Suppressed Discoveries _____ / 45
- 09. Cults, Conspiracies & Hidden Religious Truths _____ / 45
- 10. Real Crimes They Quietly Forgot _____ / 45
- 11. Hidden Histories of Famous People _____ / 45
- 12. Government Lies & Cover-Ups _____ / 45
- 13. Strange Deaths & The Mystery Files _____ / 45
- 14. Forgotten Disasters & Untold Catastrophes _____ / 45

GRAND TOTAL _____ / **630**

- 567–630** ★★★★★ **GRAND HISTORIAN**
- 504–566** ★★★★★ **KNOWLEDGE CHAMPION**
- 378–503** ★★★★★ **CURIOUS SCHOLAR**
- 252–377** ★★★★★ **KEEN LEARNER**
- Below 252** ★★★★★ **APPRENTICE**

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